IFAD EDITORIAL MANUAL

Documents and Language Services

April 2026

Main updates since June 2024

Adoption of the online Oxford Dictionary as the authority for spelling in IFAD documents

New section on referencing

Additions to inclusive language section, particularly on avoiding the use of the term "beneficiary"

Additions to abbreviation list

Additions to word index

Updated list of IFAD policies and strategies

Guidance on the use of "as of" and "as at" added

Entries preceded by an asterisk indicates a change from previous practice

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1. SPELLING

Introduction

About IFAD spelling

The online Oxford Dictionary is now the current authority for spelling in IFAD.

The IFAD word index includes entries for words commonly found in IFAD documents and for which there may be more than one possible spelling.

General guidelines

"-ize" not "-ise"

IFAD spells verbs like organize, realize and finalize with the "ize" rather than the "ise" ending (similarly, organization, realization and finalization).

Exceptions: "ise":

advertise	advise	apprise	exercise	comprise	improvise
incise	prise	revise	supervise	surmise	

Exceptions: "yse":

analyse	catalyse	paralyse	psychoanalyse

"our" not "or"

colour (not: color)
flavour (not: flavor)
neighbour (not: neighbor)

"re" not "er"

centre (not: center)
fibre (not: fiber)
metre (not: meter)

Other preferred spellings

amid (not: amidst)
among (not: amongst)
judgment (not: judgement)
while (not: whilst)
programme (not: program)

2. ABBREVIATIONS

Abbreviations can take the form of an acronym (i.e. made up of the initial letters of an organization/term and pronounced as one word, e.g. IFAD, UNICEF) or an initialism (formed in the same way but pronounced as separate letters, e.g. WFP, IMF). A list of commonly used abbreviations in IFAD documentation can be found here.

General rules

Place the abbreviation within round brackets after the name/title

The World Food Programme (WFP) was involved in the project.

If the title is spelled out within round brackets, use square brackets for the abbreviation.

… (which was funded by the World Food Programme [WFP])

No full stops

Do not separate letters by punctuation

UNDP (not: U.N.D.P.)

Exceptions: a.m.; p.m.; Washington, D.C.; N/A

Three-time rule (with flexibility)

Usually, the abbreviation is introduced on first mention if it occurs three times or more in a document. The spelled-out form may be used after the abbreviation has been introduced to improve readability or avoid a sentence made up only of abbreviations.

For example: "The farmers' organizations will sign memorandums of understanding." (not: "The FOs will sign MoUs.")

Annexes

Reintroduce the spelled-out form followed by the abbreviation within parentheses if this will improve clarity. However, if the abbreviation has been used repeatedly throughout the document and its meaning is obvious, there is no need to spell it out again.

Do not abbreviate:

IFAD governing bodies

Audit Committee; Executive Board; Governing Council
(not: EB representatives discussed the AC minutes.)

the United Nations

the Government of a Member State

Government of Finland (not: GoF)

No need to spell out:

IFAD IT NGO GDP COP G7 G20 HIV AIDS p.m. a.m.
COVID-19 CGIAR ODI
Common measurements: km cm kg

Articles

When not to use the definite article

IFAD generally does not use "the" before abbreviations.

e.g. UNICEF offered...; ....arrangements with FAO

Where the definite article is used

Names of initiatives, facilities, funds

the IMF (International Monetary Fund)

IFAD programmes, frameworks, committees and reports

the PoLG (programme of loans and grants)
the PMU (project/programme management unit)
the PBAS (performance-based allocation system)
the EMC (Executive Management Committee)
the RIDE (Report on IFAD's Development Effectiveness)
the ARIE (Annual Report on the Independent Evaluation of IFAD)

Abbreviations preceded by an indefinite article

Follow the English pronunciation:

a GDP of ___; an NPV of ___; an NGO
a AAA rating (i.e. pronounced as a "triple-A rating")

Plural abbreviations

Use a lowercase s, with no apostrophe

NGOs (not: NGO's)

Do not pluralize abbreviations of weights and measures

42 km, 10 kcal

3. CAPITALIZATION

Capitalize

- The first word of an indented list or subparagraph
- The first word in titles and headings after a colon

  For example: External review of IFAD investigative practices 2022: Report and action plan

Government: Capitalize when referring to a specific government representing a state

the Government of India

Do not capitalize: local or municipal government; government offices

Ministry/Department: Capitalize when the reference is specific

the Ministry of Agriculture of France; the United States Department of the Treasury

IFAD strategies/policies, programmes/projects and annual reports

IFAD Policy on Gender Equality and Women's Empowerment

Rural Finance Project

Annual Report on the Independent Evaluation of IFAD

Note: The full title of the policy, project or report can subsequently be shortened and written in lowercase.

***All elements of hyphenated words in titles**

Small-Scale Agricultural Development Project

Multi-Year Evaluation Strategy of the Independent Office of Evaluation of IFAD

Quick reference list

Capitalize	
Associate Vice-President	Italian Conference Room
Chairperson (of an IFAD Committee)	Management
Department (named department)	Member State
Director (of named division)	Oval Room
Division (named division)	President
Executive Board	Professional (staff)
General Counsel	P-5 (the grade)
General Service	Secretariat
Governing Council	Secretary of IFAD
Governor	Vice-President

Do not capitalize

Document parts

annex I section XI article IV table 1 graph 3

Project/programme components and phases

component 1 subcomponent B phase II

Abbreviations of units of measurement

cm kg km m^2 ha

Resolutions, regulations and rules

Governing Council resolution 239/XLVIII financial regulation IX
rule 16 of the …

General references to official documents

country strategic opportunities programme
agenda
financing agreement
Exception: Defined terms in legal documents (…hereinafter the "Agreement").

Agenda items when listed in minutes and Chairperson's reports

The Executive Board agenda contained the following items: (i) opening of the session; (ii) strategic discussion with the President of IFAD; and (iii) Report on IFAD's Development Effectiveness.

Quick reference list

Lowercase	
budget officer	member (of a committee)
cafeteria	programme assistant
country director	reception desk
delegates/delegations	representative (of Member State)*
delegates' lounge	resident coordinators
IFAD headquarters	room B-322

Note: "representative" (as in, "the representative of France") is a generic term, not a title. But: the Permanent Representative of Algeria (because "Permanent Representative" is an official title).

4. HYPHENATION

Introduction

When hyphenating compound words, the overriding concern should be clarity and consistency.

Check the word index or the online Oxford Dictionary to see if an entry exists for the term in question.

Hyphenate

Compound modifiers consisting of more than two elements

non-interest-bearing notes
upper-middle-income countries
step-by-step guidelines
how-to-do notes

Noun + -ing compound modifying a noun

institution-strengthening measures
decision-making authority

Noun + adjective compounds, in all instances

climate-smart technology; technology that is climate-smart
food-insecure households; households that are food-insecure
gender-transformative approach; an approach that is gender-transformative

Split compounds

As a general rule, use a hyphen after each modifier with a space after the first hyphen

report on short- and long-term debt
short-, medium- and long-term objectives

but: small and medium-sized enterprises
(since "small" is not part of a compound modifier here)
and: macro- and microeconomics

Any compound modifier preceding a noun when ambiguity might otherwise result

cold-storage vaults (i.e. vaults for cold storage, not storage vaults that are cold)

more-strategic activities (i.e. activities that are more strategic, not an increased number of strategic activities)

Ordinal numbers

forty-seventh

Compound units of measurement

person-year kilowatt-hours

Cardinal numbers up to 100 (in cases where the spelled-out form is used, e.g. in some legal texts)

twenty-one fifty-four
but: one hundred and twenty

No hyphenation

In compounds formed by two nouns, the trend is not to hyphenate

cost recovery crop husbandry decision maker knowledge management

Noun + noun compounds modifying a third noun

For frequently occurring terms, the preference is not to hyphenate.

water supply project value chain approach

Hyphenate

When the second word is a gerund, the trend is to hyphenate.

awareness-raising capacity-building knowledge-sharing

Exceptions

Written as a single word:

bookkeeping	childbearing	housekeeping
moneylending	peacebuilding	peacekeeping
policymaking	stocktaking	

Written as two words:

cost accounting	crop dusting	data processing
drug trafficking	family planning	alley cropping

Fractions

No hyphenation as a noun:	**Hyphenate when an adjective or adverb:**
three quarters of the votes	a three-quarter share
two thirds of the population	a two-thirds majority

Note: A hyphen should also be used when compound numbers are involved: five one-hundredths.

Number + unit of measurement

a five-year-old pledge
a three-day seminar
a 10-year-old child

5. NUMBERS, MEASUREMENTS, DATES AND TIMES

Cardinal numbers

Write out numbers up to nine

The project targets five regions.

Use figures from 10 and above

The project will be implemented in 10 regions and reach 5,000 smallholder households.

Exception: Sentences beginning with a number:

Twenty-five smallholder farmers attended the workshop.

For series above and below 10, use figures only

There are 12 African, 8 Asian and 5 European countries involved.
(not: There are 12 African, eight Asian and five European...)

For statistics and measurements, use figures

Globally, 1.4 billion people, primarily in rural areas in developing countries, do not have access to formal financial products and services.

By project completion, 9 km of feeder roads had been upgraded.

Percentages

Express in figures

Wages increased by 1 per cent.
At least 70 per cent of the project participants will be women.

Word or % sign?

Spell out in running text.

Only 38 per cent of GDP…
When expressing percentages as a range in running text
Between 40 and 55 per cent of community members joined the committee.
(no need to repeat "per cent")

Use percentage sign only in tables and figures.

Ordinal numbers

IFAD meetings up to 99

The forty-eighth session of the Governing Council

From 100 onwards

The 145th session of the Executive Board

For most ordinary purposes

She was the ninth farmer interviewed.

Note: For larger numbers, use figures with superscript:

The country ranked 67th in the Human Development Index.

To indicate floors

2nd floor; 7th floor

Currencies

Write out

Isolated and general references to currency

"… denominated in special drawing rights and United States dollars."

In President's reports – recommendation section

RESOLVED: that the Fund shall provide a loan designated in euro on highly concessional terms to [official country name] in the amount of eleven million seven hundred and fifty-five thousand euros (EUR 11,755,000) …

Table/graph headings

Table 1
Project costs by component and financier
(Thousands of United States dollars)

Note: As a general rule, ISO three-letter codes (EUR, GBP, CAD, etc.) are used for currency abbreviations in the **running text** of English governing body documents (e.g. EUR 50,000, XOF 3,000).

However, in the case of the United States dollar, the currency symbol (US$) is used as it is more reader-friendly and recognizable (US$1,200,000).

Spacing

With a symbol

No space between symbol and number

US$5 million

With a letter

Add space

EUR 5 million SDR 4.3 million

Exchange rates

When to write out currencies

In isolated occurrences in text, write out in long form.

The exchange rate was 250 Mexican pesos to 1 United States dollar.

Frequently occurring references in financial documents

The EUR:US$ exchange rate changed from EUR 0.897:US$1 to EUR 0.841:US$1.

Dates

Follow the day-month-year order

21 April 2025

Use cardinal numbers

21 April (not: 21st April)

Date ranges

In running text

The forty-ninth session of the Governing Council will be held **on 10 and 11** February.

The meeting will be held **from 23 to 26 November**.

Document cover pages, tables and titles: use an en dash with no spaces (–)

23–24 November 2025

Centuries

Write out: nineteenth century (not: the 19th century)

Time of day

IFAD uses the 12-hour system

In running text

8 a.m. (not 8:00 a.m.)

9 a.m. to 1.30 p.m.

9 a.m. to 10 a.m.

noon: not 12 p.m.

midnight: not 12 a.m.

Use the 24-hour system for timetables and schedules

09.00–12.30	Keynote address
16.30–17.00	Closing remarks

Ranges

Linking numbers in running text

From … to …: "The Committee will convene from 12 to 23 April."

Between … and …: "… for girls between 10 and 15 years of age."

For dates and percentages, separate figures with the word "to".

Inflation rose from 3.5 to 6 per cent.

For measurements, use an en dash

"… to increase by an additional 2–4 kg."

Express in different styles to distinguish between different elements

15 five-phase schemes
three 2-year plans

A period covering two or more full calendar years

2010–2015 the biennium 2004–2005

A period of less than 24 months that straddles two years

2017/2018
In financial year 2018/2019, IFAD…

Use the same style for two numbers in a range

Between 3,430,500 and 4,500,000 housing units were built
(not: 3,430,500 and 4.5 million)

Express numbers in full

Earnings increased from US$2 million to US$5 million
(not: US$2 to US$5 million)

Governing Council resolutions 139/XXX to 141/XXX
(not: 139 to 141/XXX)

Ranges with symbols: repeat symbol

The temperature rose from 15° C to 30° C. (not: 15 to 30° C)

Tickets for the match cost between US$20 and US$25.
(not: US$20 and 25)

Ranges with word or abbreviation: do not repeat

… ranged from 3 to 6 per cent (not: 3 per cent to 6 per cent)

The convoy travelled at only 45–50 km an hour.

Symbols

No space between numbers and symbols

10° US$15 75%

Negative amounts

In text: use the "−" sign or spell out the word "minus" to avoid ambiguity.

Negative interest rates, ranging from −3 to −2 per cent…

The budget balance is minus EUR 6.5 million.

In tables

Use brackets (not the minus sign) to denote negatives: (10) **not:** −10

Roman numerals

Uppercase

Annexes, appendices and attachments to IFAD documents

annex I, appendix III

Governing Council session numbers in resolutions and decisions

Governing Council resolution 238/XLVIII

Lowercase

Lists in running text, use lowercase and place within parentheses

The project will support: (i) value chain development; (ii) market access; and (iii) small-scale irrigation.

Punctuation

In running text

Whole numbers of more than three digits are punctuated as follows:

2,632,597

In tables

A space replaces the punctuation marks in whole numbers of more than three digits. A column of numbers is presented as follows:

10 530 600
632 597
1 326

Fractions and decimals

Write out

Simple fractions

Almost three quarters of the population had to be evacuated.

Express in figures

Compound fractions and decimals

The accident occurred 2 1/4 miles from the checkpoint.
Costs fell by 1.75 per cent in 2024 and 0.85 per cent in 2025.

Always include a "0" before the decimal point.

0.8 per cent (not: .8 per cent)

Ratios and map scales

Use numbers and a separating colon

A cofinancing ratio of 1:1.2 … A new map on the scale 1:250,000 …

Use a hyphen not a slash to express simple ratios

debt-equity ratio (not: debt/equity ratio)

In more complex cases, spell out the ratio

ratio of long-term debt to equity
ratio of current assets to current liabilities

Numbers only

Weights, measures and distances

The hotel is located 500 metres from the station.
The yield was 3 tons per hectare.

Note: In measurements of less than one, express in the singular.

0.25 percentage point 0.5 ton

Abbreviations: Use lowercase. No punctuation.

120 kg
100 cm, 50 cm^2

Ages

Mortality rates declined for children under 5 years of age.

Temperatures

10.15° C 92° F −20° C

Note: There is a space between the degree symbol (°) and F or C.

Page numbers

In running text: "see pages 19–26". In footnotes or within parentheses: "see pp. 19–26"

Results of voting

The resolution was adopted by 15 votes to none, with 65 abstentions.
The resolution was rejected by 26 votes to 9, with 1 abstention.

Note: In votes, the word "none" is always used instead of the figure "0". The majority vote is always given first.

Thousands, millions, billions and trillions

In running text, write

1 million
3.4 million

Commas versus full stops

US$1.477 million = US$1,477,000
US$1,477 million = US$1,477,000,000

Billion

In the United Nations system, 10^9 (1,000,000,000)

US$1 billion = 1 thousand million dollars (not: 1 million million)

Note: US$1 billion = French 1 *milliard* and Spanish 1 *mil millón*
US$1 trillion = French 1 *billion* and Spanish 1 *billón*

Quick conversion table for thousands/millions/billions

Actual figure	*Thousands*	*Millions*	*In letters*
10 000	10	0.01	ten thousand
100 000	100	0.1	one hundred thousand
1 000 000	1 000	1.0	one million
10 000 000	10 000	10	ten million
100 000 000	100 000	100	one hundred million
1 000 000 000	1 000 000	1 000	one billion

6. GRAMMAR, PUNCTUATION AND STYLE

Quotations and quotation marks

Double quotation marks

Quoted words, sentences and paragraphs

It would give IFAD "the right to decide" … (not: 'the right to decide')

Around specialized terms when they are first introduced and defined

Thereafter, these words should be written without quotation marks.

Single quotation marks

To differentiate quotations within quotations

Rule 60 states that "the phrase 'members present and voting' means members casting an affirmative or negative vote".

Direct quotations

General rule

Reproduce the original text exactly and check carefully for accuracy.

Permitted text changes

The initial letter may be changed to a capital or lowercase letter.
The final punctuation may be omitted.
The original footnotes and footnote indicators may be omitted.
Typographical and other clearly unintentional errors may be corrected.

Quotations of a complete paragraph of more than five typed lines

Set off as an indented block of text.

Punctuation and quotation marks

Place full stops and commas outside quotation marks when the cited text is not a full sentence.

The Chairperson referred to rule 28, which allows for amendment "to the extent that such amendment is consistent with the Agreement".

Place full stops and commas inside quotation marks when the cited text is a full sentence (or multiple sentences)

"The Executive Board approved the document at its most recent session."

Omissions

Use an ellipsis (three dots with a space on either side) to mark omissions within a quotation.

> "The Fund shall provide resources … on highly concessional terms."

Note: Omissions at the start or end of a quotation do not need to be flagged.

Indicate a paragraph omission within a block quotation by inserting the ellipsis points on a separate line of text and align them with the normal paragraph indents.

Square brackets within quotations

Use square brackets to insert or alter words in a direct quotation. The brackets enclose words intended to clarify meaning, provide a brief explanation or integrate the quote into the sentence.

> "Within the framework of the above-mentioned priorities, eligibility for assistance is [determined] on the basis of objective economic and social criteria with special emphasis on [the needs of] low-income countries."

Footnotes within quotations

Omit unless the meaning or purpose of the quotation would be obscured without the footnote.

If the footnote must be retained, keep the original footnote number and place the footnote directly below the quotation, separated by a 10-space line. The final quotation marks should follow the footnote.

Quotations from resolutions, decisions and IFAD documents

Short passages from resolutions and reports may be presented as an indirect quotation and are therefore not enclosed by quotation marks. Wording that is not strictly relevant may be omitted but the wording should adhere as closely as possible to the original text.

Indirect reported speech

The minutes of governing body meetings are written using indirect reported speech.

Direct reported speech: "I commend our Governors for their excellent proposals," said the Chairperson.

Indirect reported speech: The Chairperson commended the Governors' proposals.

Note: See the United Nations Editorial Manual for more detailed guidelines.

Commas

Serial comma/Oxford comma

"and" is not preceded by a comma before the last element in a series

> Argentina, France **and** Switzerland ...

Unless the final or next-but-last element contains "and"

Various initiatives will be implemented to improve supervision, monitoring **and** evaluation**,** and transparency in operations.

Comma placement

It is important to use commas in pairs in parenthetical constructions:

In article 4, paragraph 6(a)**,** of the Agreement …

Complex lists

Use semicolons to punctuate lists already containing commas to clearly separate each element in the list. Example:

The meeting was attended by: the Vice-President; the Associate Vice-President and Chief Financial Officer, Financial Operations Department; the Associate Vice-President, Corporate Services Department; and the Chief Legal and Governance Officer, Office of Legal and Governance.

Apostrophes

Do not use with

Decades (the 1970s; the mid-1950s)
Plural form of acronyms (NGOs; SMEs)
but:
four years' grace (= four years of grace)
two hours' work (= two hours of work) one hour's work

Possessives

Apostrophe + s

Possessive of singular nouns, even for words or names ending in -s or -z

Ms Pérez's suggestion; the hostess's invitation
Ms Jones's appointment

Some exceptions (mostly historical expressions)

Achilles' heel in Jesus' name

Apostrophe + no added s

Possessive of plural nouns

Ministry of Fisheries' budget
Indigenous Peoples' organizations

Note: the United Nations development system (not: the United Nations' development system)

en dash

To set off phrases within a sentence: use an en dash (–) not a hyphen (-)

Leave a space before and after each dash

The agency – and not its predecessor – is being ...

Round brackets ( )

In normal circumstances and for abbreviations

The Vice-President (representing IFAD) met with representatives of the World Food Programme (WFP).

For paragraph subdivisions within round brackets
... as indicated earlier (see section 4(b))

Punctuation with round brackets

Full stop within a closing bracket only if the words form a complete sentence.

(See annex III for details.)

Square brackets [ ]

Use square brackets when parenthetical information needs to be inserted into text already enclosed by parentheses.

IFAD will work with development partners in the target area
(e.g. the African Development Bank [AfDB]).

In algebraic expressions

[(x + y) + z]

e.g. (for example)

Use in parenthetical references and do not follow with a comma

... items (e.g. computers, printers and scanners)

In running text, write the words out in full

... a number of problems**, for example,** the lack of ...

i.e. (abbreviation of the Latin id est, "that is")

Use in parenthetical references and do not follow with a comma

(i.e. the Audit Committee)

etc.

Always preceded by a comma and followed by full stop

... machinery, equipment, etc.

Note: Do not use "etc." in phrases introduced by "e.g.", "including", "such as" or "for example" as these indicate that the list is not exhaustive.

Ibid.

In footnotes

10. Agreement Establishing IFAD, article 3, section 1(a).
11. Ibid., article 6, section 2(c).

Italics

Used for the following:

Some foreign words
Latin names of animal and plant species
Titles of laws and decrees in a foreign language
Titles of books, publications, periodicals, newspapers, films, plays, and radio and television programmes

Not used for the following:

Emphasis
Non-English names of organizations, institutions and corporations
Quotations

Bound spaces/soft returns

To keep two numbers or words from splitting at line break, insert a bound space between them. In Word, press Ctrl + Shift + space bar.

US$2.1[ ]million 16[ ]per[ ]cent Mr[ ]Michael[ ]Smith

Addresses

Note the placement of commas, "Via" is capitalized

IFAD, Via Paolo di Dono 44, 00142 Rome

Style

Consistency

Make sure that names, titles, places, projects, policies, departments, numbers, years and statistics are correct and referred to consistently throughout the document.

Common inconsistencies within the same document

Project or programme	*First reference*: "The Rural Development Programme will last ..."	
	Later reference: "The project's components are as follows: …"	
Loan/grant amounts	*First:*	"… a grant of US$7.5 million."
	Later:	"… in addition to the grant of US$7.6 million, IFAD…"
Dates	*First:*	"The project was approved in 2024 …"
	Later:	"After its approval in 2025 …"
Statistics	*First:*	"The project aims to help 10,000 smallholder farmers."
	Later:	"The target group includes 11,000 smallholder farmers …"
Project titles	*First:*	"… regarding the Rural Smallholder Farmer Project …"
	Later:	"… as before in the Rural Smallholding Farmer Project."

Use of "as"

as at (followed by specific date, used particularly in financial texts)
Status of contributions as at 31 December 2025

as of (followed by month but no date)
As of December 2025, the policy will come into effect.

Avoid "as well as" unless the elements preceding it are the additional items and the items following are the core element:

This project's main objective is healthcare support. However, it will provide basic housing as well as healthcare services.

shall/will

In contracts and other legal documents

Shall: an undertaking by, for example, a borrower or guarantor
Will: expresses future or contingent action on the part of IFAD

7. GEOGRAPHICAL NAMES

Introduction

The official names of IFAD Member States are listed in the CIAO2.0 database. Three ways of writing the name are provided: formal, informal and short.

The formal name is used for:

Cover pages of COSOPs and project proposals

Recommendation sections of President's reports for project proposals

Official correspondence

The first mention of the country in running text of the document

The short name is used in:

Tables and figures

Common errors and incorrect forms

Country names in common use may differ from the names used in an official diplomatic context. Always check the CIAO database to ensure that the correct form is used.

Name in tables	*In running text*	***Incorrect form***
Bolivia (Plurinational State of)	Plurinational State of Bolivia	Bolivia
Cabo Verde	-	Cape Verde
Congo	-	Congo (Rep.)
Democratic Republic of the Congo	-	D.R. Congo
Gambia (The)	The Gambia	Gambia
Guinea-Bissau	-	Guinea Bissau
Iceland	-	Republic of Iceland
Iran (Islamic Republic of)	-	Iran
Côte d'Ivoire	-	Ivory Coast
Democratic People's Republic of Korea	-	North Korea
Republic of Korea	-	South Korea
Lao People's Democratic Republic	-	Laos
North Macedonia	-	Macedonia
Micronesia (Federated States of)	Federated States of Micronesia	Micronesia
Republic of Moldova	-	Moldova
Netherlands (Kingdom of the)	Kingdom of the Netherlands	Netherlands
Russian Federation	-	Russia
Eswatini	-	Swaziland (formerly)
Syrian Arab Republic	-	Syria
United Republic of Tanzania	-	Tanzania
Türkiye	-	Turkey
Venezuela (Bolivarian Republic of)	Bolivarian Republic of Venezuela	Venezuela
Timor-Leste	-	Timor Leste
Viet Nam	-	Vietnam

Alphabetization

List in alphabetical order, usually by short name

"… from **C**anada, **S**udan and **V**iet Nam"

Alphabetize by key word in the short form

e.g.: **B**olivia (Plurinational State of) = B not P

"The" is not taken into account for alphabetization purposes

The **B**ahamas and France (not: France and **T**he Bahamas)

Capitalization of place names

Capitalize common nouns (singular or plural) or adjectives when used as part of a proper name. When the common noun is used alone as a substitute for the name of a place, do not capitalize.

the Nile Delta	the delta
Atyrau Region	the region

Also: Lakes Tanganyika, Victoria and Albert but the Indian and Pacific oceans

Points of the compass

Capitalize in reference to a major region or in a political context

West Africa, South-East Asia

Do not capitalize in reference to geographical direction or an area within a country

The ICO is located in the east of the country (not: in the East)
The project is being implemented in northern Uganda (not: in Northern Uganda)

Use hyphen for compound forms

Located in north-eastern Nigeria
in the south-west of Azerbaijan

In project titles, capitalize both elements

North-East Development Project

8. INCLUSIVE LANGUAGE

Diversity at IFAD

IFAD is committed to respecting and promoting diversity in its work and workplace. It values a diversity-rich workforce, free of discrimination as to ethnic, social or political background, colour, nationality, religion, age, sex, disability, marital status, family size or sexual orientation. For further information see the IFAD Strategy on Diversity, Equity and Inclusion: Update.

Language in official documents

The language used in IFAD documents should not marginalize people or groups of people on the basis of gender, cultural background, physical ability or any other potentially discriminatory factor.

Gendered and gender neutral terms

Language identifying gender should only be used when deemed necessary for the sake of clarity. If using a gendered term does not add value to the sentence, consider using a gender neutral term. For additional guidance on the use of inclusive language see the United Nations guidelines for gender inclusive language.

Alternatives to using a gendered pronoun

Use the plural – they, them or their
Rephrase the sentence to omit the use of a pronoun
Replace "his" with "the" or "a"
Use the pronoun "one"

Exclusionary terms and proposed alternatives

brotherhood	solidarity; human fellowship; human kinship
businessmen	business owners; business operators
camera man	camera operator; camera crew (plural)
chairman	chairperson; chair
founding fathers	founders
gentleman's agreement	honourable agreement; unwritten agreement
husbands/wives	spouses; partners
landlord	owner; proprietor
man	person; individual
manhood	adulthood
mankind	humanity
man-months/years	person-months/years
manpower	workforce; labour force; workers
middleman	intermediary
policeman	police officer
spokesman	spokesperson; representative
to man (verb) a project	to hire personnel for a project

Additional gender neutral terminology

ombudsman, ombudsmen (gender neutral)

rapporteur (m., f.)

Persons with disabilities

The "people-first" approach should always be favoured. The term "disabled people" places the emphasis on the disability, not the person. "Persons with disabilities" is the preferred term.

Note: PwD is not an approved acronym for persons with disabilities and should not be used.

For further guidance, see the **United Nations disability-inclusive language guidelines**.

Indigenous Peoples

The term "Indigenous Peoples" is a common denominator for more than 476 million persons, representing 6.2 percent of the world's population. IFAD uses a working definition based on various criteria listed in its **Policy on Engagement with Indigenous Peoples**.

Capitalize when referring to cultures, communities, lands, languages:

Indigenous Peoples

Indigenous culture in Ecuador

Indigenous languages are dying out

Lowercase if referring to flora or fauna

indigenous plants

Possessive

Indigenous Peoples' organizations

* Beneficiaries

IFAD no longer uses the term "beneficiary". We now refer to the people we work with as project participants or find a suitable alternative, depending on the context.

9. FOREIGN, LATIN AND GREEK TERMS

Foreign terms

Italicize if not in the online Oxford Dictionary

e.g. *salle d'écoute*

"Observers followed the session from the *salle d'écoute.*"

If it is "naturalized in English", do not underline or use italics

a posteriori
a priori
an a priori argument; decided a priori
ad hoc (no hyphen)
ad infinitum
ad interim
(often abbreviated to a.i. for job titles – there should be no comma between job title and "ad interim" and "a.i.")
campesino (n., adj.)
circa
Used in footnotes – Data circa 1983. – or in brackets (circa 1981).
de facto
de jure
dirigisme
elite
en route (adj., adv.)
ex ante (no hyphen)
ex post (no hyphen)
fait accompli
(pl.: faits accomplis)
force majeure
a force majeure clause
in situ
inter alia
laissez-faire
laissez-passer (n.)
(singular is same as plural)
modus operandi
mutatis mutandis
pari passu per diem (rate); **per diems** (monies received for living expenses);
per diem allowance
five times the per diem rate; a payment equal to five per diems
per se
pro forma (adj.)
pro forma equality; pro forma balance sheet; pro forma invoice
pro rata (adj., adv.)
a pro rata assessment; a decision to assess costs pro rata
quasi
Use a hyphen in compound nouns and adjectives containing this term
(n.) quasi-corporation
(adj.) quasi-corporate
rapporteur (m., f.)
rapprochement
regime
rendezvous
sic
Latin term that signals to the reader an error being copied exactly from another source (spelling or grammar error, or a number that is evidently incorrect).
sine qua non
Means "without which not"; an indispensable requisite or condition.
tsunami, tsunamis
versus (not: vs, vs.)
vice versa

Keep accent but do not italicize

café
raison d'être
vis-à-vis
El Niño, La Niña
émigré
résumé
démarche
détente
attaché
cliché
communiqué
coup d'état (pl.: coups d'état)

For project- and country-specific terms, use italics, keep accents and provide translation

kolkhoz (collective farm)
raion (administrative district)

Foreign addresses in translations

Legal texts

In legal texts such as proposed resolutions, reproduce the address exactly as it appears in the source language.

Correspondence

Translate the city, state or province, and country, and reproduce the rest of the address in the original language (including any abbreviation used for boulevard, avenida, etc.).

Foreign terms: plural forms

addendum, addenda (not addendums)
aide-memoire
aides-memoires
bureau
bureaux
antennae (for insects)
antennas (aerials)
appendix, appendices (not appendixes)
biennium, bienniums (two-year period)
colloquium, colloquiums
compendium, compendiums
corrigendum, corrigenda
criterion, criteria
curriculum, curricula (plural: curricula vitae)
encyclopedia, encyclopedias but: the *Encyclopaedia Britannica*
formula, formulas (Use formulae only in scientific and mathematical contexts)
forum, forums (not fora)
honorariums
indices (statistical), **indexes** (lists in a book)
larva, larvae
matrix, matrices
medium, media
medium of exchange, media Media takes a plural verb in all senses (including the press, radio and television): "The media are interested..."
memorandum, memorandums (not memoranda)
millenniums (not millennia)
moratoriums
note verbale
notes verbales
nucleus, nuclei
referendum, referendums (not referenda)
symposium, symposiums
thesis, theses

Accents in place names

Drop the accent if the name has become naturalized in English

Brasilia Haiti Montreal, etc.

Accents on capital letters

In English texts, retain accents on uppercase words in all languages

FÊTE SALLE D'ÉCOUTE ÉTAT

Alphabetization of surnames

As a general rule, alphabetize using the "letter by letter" system, ignoring intervening word spaces.

Cabañas
Cyrilson
DaCosta, T.
da Costa, V.
da Cunha
de Beauvoir
De Falco
de la Torre
López

Chinese names

Word order

The family name traditionally is placed before the given name (which can consist of two elements).

In English, the salutation in a letter written in response to one signed by "Chen Yuan" would be "Dear Mr Chen", not "Dear Mr Yuan".

10. TITLES, HONORIFICS AND GOVERNMENT TERMS

IFAD correspondence

Salutations

CIAO2.0 is the official source for information on Member State contacts.

	English salutations	
Addressee	*Opening salutation*	*Complimentary close*
Member States		
Head of State	Excellency/Excellencies	Accept, Excellency, the assurances of my highest consideration.
Head of Government	Excellency/Excellencies	Accept, Excellency, the assurances of my highest consideration.
Minister	Excellency/Excellencies	Accept, Excellency, the assurances of my highest consideration.
Ambassador or Minister Plenipotentiary	Excellency/Excellencies	Accept, Excellency, the assurances of my highest consideration.
Secretary-General	Dear Mr Secretary-General,	Yours sincerely,
Heads of Organizations and Agencies	Dear Mr [Surname], or Dear Ms [Surname],	Yours sincerely,
Other Embassy, Ministry or Organization staff	Dear Mr [Surname], or Dear Ms [Surname],	Yours sincerely,
Special roles at IFAD		
Governor of IFAD (rank of Ambassador and above)	Distinguished Governor,	Accept, Distinguished Governor, the assurances of my highest consideration.
Governor of IFAD (below the rank of Ambassador)	Mr Governor or Madam Governor,	Yours sincerely,
Executive Board Representative (rank of Ambassador and above)*	Distinguished Executive Board Representative,	Accept, Distinguished Executive Board Representative, the assurances of my highest consideration.
Executive Board Representative (below the rank of Ambassador)	Mr Executive Board Representative, or Madam Executive Board Representative,	Yours sincerely,
Circular letters**		
Governors	Distinguished Governors,	Accept, Distinguished Governors, the assurances of my highest consideration.
Executive Board Representatives	Distinguished Executive Board Representatives,	Accept, Distinguished Executive Board Representatives, the assurances of my highest consideration.

* Executive Board Representative is written with a capital “R” only in opening and closing salutations. Elsewhere a lowercase “r” is used.

** On occasions when a letter is addressed to multiple addressees such as Governors or Executive Board Representatives.

Ms and Mr

First letter capitalized, no full stops

Mr Smith Ms Smith

Ambassador/Embassy

Ambassador of [country] to [country/organization]

… the Ambassador of Germany to Kenya.

Embassy of [country] in [country]

The Embassy of Sweden in Saudi Arabia

Forms of address

Her/His Excellency [name], Ambassador of [country] to [country]

Her Excellency Jane Smith, Ambassador of Australia to Ghana

–elect, -designate

Members of an official party of an incoming president

Mr John Smith, President-elect [of _____]
John Smith, Vice-President-elect (or Vice-President-designate)
_____, Minister-designate for Finance
_____, Director-General-designate, Finance Division, ...

Ambassadors: Avoid "designate", use "appointed"

His Excellency John Smith, Appointed Ambassador of Italy to France

Excellency, Excellencies

Title blocks in addresses delivered at the Governing Council

Address by His Excellency John Smith, President of _____ at ___

Honorific followed by a name

Her Excellency Martha Grimes, Ambassador of ___ to ___

Honorific without a name

... to welcome His Excellency, the President of ___

Government, government

Treat as a singular noun

The Government has pledged ...

Capitalize

Specific references to a government representing a state

the Government of France; the Governments of Haiti and Guatemala

Lowercase

Generic references

local or municipal government
a change of government

When used as an adjective

government institution

Minister for/Ministry of

Uppercase

Specific references

the Minister for Agriculture of India/the Ministry of Agriculture of India

Lowercase

Unmodified plural forms

representatives of several ministries
There will be three ministers on the committee.

President (of a country)

Uppercase

when referring to a specific person

His Excellency ___, President of the Argentine Republic
the President-elect of Ecuador

Note: Avoid the informal style of President + surname.

Secretary-General, Secretaries-General

Hyphenation

Follow official spelling

Secretary-General (of the United Nations)
Secretary General (of the European Bank for Reconstruction and Development)

University degrees

Lowercase

a bachelor of arts in history (not: a Bachelor of Arts …)
holds a master's degree in science (not: a Master's degree…)

Abbreviations – note capitalization

BA BSc MA MSc MBA PhD

Other diplomatic titles

chargé d'affaires

As a specific title: Chargé d'affaires of the Permanent Mission

Minister-Counsellor (plural: Ministers-Counsellor)

11. IFAD GOVERNANCE: MEETINGS, SESSIONS AND TERMINOLOGY

Session or meeting? Governor, member or representative?

Name	*Session or meeting?*	*Participants*
Body		
• **Governing Council**	session	Governors
• **Executive Board**	session	representatives
• **Evaluation Committee**	session	members
• **Audit Committee**	meeting	members
• **Consultation on the [-] Replenishment of IFAD's Resources**	session	members
Others		
• **Ad Hoc Working Group on Governance**	meeting	Governors
• **Convenors and Friends**	meeting	convenors or friends
• **PBAS Working Group**	meeting	members

Documentation for presentation at governing body meetings must be prepared using the correct template and follow the guidelines on word count set forth in the President's Bulletin on Revised Corporate Guidelines for Governing Body Documents, issued in February 2022.

Member State/member

Uppercase

Member States of IFAD
Member States of United Nations agencies
non-Member States
Membership; IFAD Membership (collective term for all Member States)

Note: Membership should be lowercased when used as an adjective (i.e. membership votes).

Lowercase

IFAD's governing bodies

Consultation on the XXX Replenishment of IFAD's Resources

This year-long exercise comprises a series of sessions convened by the Governing Council between IFAD and its Member States to decide on the replenishment level and other high-level matters for the next replenishment cycle.

Uppercase

Consultation on the Fourteenth Replenishment of IFAD's Resources
The Governing Council approved the Report of the Consultation on the Fourteenth Replenishment of IFAD's Resources (IFAD14 Report).
The Governing Council adopted the Resolution on the Fourteenth Replenishment of IFAD's Resources (IFAD14 Resolution).

Note: When referring to draft versions of the above documents, lowercase "draft", i.e. draft IFAD14 Report; draft IFAD14 Resolution

Lowercase "member" when referring to the individuals representing a country

During the session, Consultation members discussed the IFAD12 business model.

Uppercase

Member

When the reference is clearly to the Member State – for example, "Members' pledges"

When possible, it is preferable to make the distinction clear by referring always to "Member State" rather than "Member".

the External Chair of the Consultation

Governing Council/Governor

Uppercase

Governor
Alternate Governor

Usage

The Governor for Pakistan … (not: "of" Pakistan)
Distinguished Governors

Do not abbreviate to "GC" in official documents.
The Governing Council convenes in sessions.

Executive Board/representative

Lowercase

When referring to IFAD Executive Board representatives

The representative of Nigeria asked …

Uppercase

In official correspondence for opening and closing salutations:

Distinguished Representative,
Accept, Distinguished Representative, the assurances of my highest consideration.

Note: The Executive Board convenes in sessions. Do not abbreviate to "EB" in official documents.

Audit Committee/member

Lowercase

Audit Committee member
Audit Committee meeting

Uppercase

Audit Committee Chairperson

Note: The Audit Committee convenes in meetings. Do not abbreviate to "AC" in official documents.

Committee is generally treated as a singular noun

the Committee is meeting today
for its (the Committee's) information

Although occasionally a plural form may be appropriate ("the committee were asked for their opinions", i.e. the members of the committee were asked ...)

Evaluation Committee/representative

Lowercase

Evaluation Committee representative
Evaluation Committee session

Uppercase

Evaluation Committee Chairperson

Note: The Evaluation Committee convenes in sessions. Do not abbreviate to "EC" in official documents.

Member States: Lists

Note: Refer to the Agreement Establishing IFAD for an explanation of IFAD Lists.

List A
List B
List C: sub-List C1, sub-List C2 and sub-List C3
Lists A, B and C
members of this List
statements by the Lists

President

Uppercase

When referring to a specific person

the President's statement, the former President of IFAD

Use lowercase when the sense is generic

Generic sense

IFAD has had many presidents since its founding.

Management

Uppercase

When referring to the cadre of officials of IFAD

After reviewing the situation, Management decided …

Lowercase

In normal usage

programme management; financial management

IFAD has three management mechanisms

Executive Management Committee (EMC)
Operations Management Committee (OMC)
Senior Management Team (SMT)

Secretary of IFAD

Always use the full title

The Secretary of IFAD invited…
(not: The Secretary… or the IFAD Secretary…)
Office of the Secretary

Chairperson

Use uppercase (the Chairperson) when the reference is to the head officer of the Governing Council or the Executive Board, or any meeting of a standing or ad hoc committee of those bodies

the Chairperson of the Audit Committee.

The term "constituency" is used to refer to a country or country group's seat on the Board.

Action taken by governing bodies

Depending on the meeting and item, governing bodies are invited to **review, approve, authorize or adopt** documents.

12. TABLES

Overview

This is a typical example of a table found in IFAD documents.

Table 1
Indicative programme costs by expenditure category and financier
(Thousands of United States dollars)

	Borrower/ counterpart		*IFAD loan*		*Cofinancier*		*Total*	
Expense category	*Amount*	*%*	*Amount*	*%*	*Amount*	*%*	*Amount*	*%*
1. Works	3 042.5	7.6	8 798.3	21.9	28 407.6	70.6	40 248.3	61.7
2. Vehicles	716.9	71.0	292.8	29.0	-	-	1 009.7	1.5
3. Equipment and materials	7.1	7.6	86.6	92.4	-	-	93.7	0.1
4. Consultancies	28.9	0.8	1 925.0	53.8	764.9	21.4	3 577.0	5.5
5. Training	197.9	1.6	2 943.5	64.5	-	-	4 562.8	7.0
6. Goods services and inputs	235.3	6.9	1 945.6	56.8	-	-	3 424.0	5.3
7. Matching grants and associated investments	-	-	5 155.5	100	-	-	5 155.5	7.9
8. Credit guarantee scheme [a]	-	-	2 978.3	100			2 978.3	4.6
9. Staff salaries and allowances [b]	528.4	14.1	3 224.7	85.9	-	-	3 753.1	5.8
10. Operating costs	173.3	44.8	213.9	55.2	-	-	387.2	0.6
Total project costs	**4 930.2**	**7.6**	**27 564.1**	**42.3**	**29 172.5**	**44.8**	**65 189.5**	**100.0**

[a] In conjunction with AfDB.
[b] To be managed by country director.

Bolding and italics

Rows of totals in bold (as above)

Column headers should be in italics and not bold

Follow this example for the bolding of a table title:

> Table 1
> **Indicative programme costs by expenditure category and financier**
> (Thousands of United States dollars)

Fonts

Table title:	Arial 9 – table number and table title
	Arial 8 – currency/percentage
Within table:	Arial 8
Footnotes:	Arial 8

Lines

No vertical lines

Bottom line and the line under column headers: 1.5 points width and bold

Top line and all other horizontal lines: 0.5 points width

Break in line between columns: 3 points, "white" colour

Numbers

Space not comma for thousands: 27 564.10 (not: 27,564.10)

When a monetary amount is "nothing" it should be indicated with a hyphen "-"

No need to repeat symbols (%/$ etc.) next to numbers, when already included in column heading.

Negative numbers should be in brackets (not with a minus sign)

Minus 250 = (250) not -250

Alignment

Column wording: bottom left

Numbers: bottom right

"Total" or "Subtotal" indent from left

Total lines: centre words and numbers

Spacing

Aim to fit table across page, portrait layout

Note: If too large it is acceptable to use landscape layout.

Consistent row height

Space between title above table and footnotes below: 3−4 points

Footnotes in tables

If there is only one footnote, use the * symbol.

For multiple footnotes, use letters (a, b, c, etc.) – do not use numbers.

Leave space between word and footnote symbol/letter for clarity:

Contributions [a] (not Contributions[a])

Quick conversion table for thousands of thousands into millions

Useful for tables in thousands of dollars/euros:

Thousands	*In millions*	*Actual figure*
10	0.01	10 000
100	0.1	100 000
1 000	1.0	1 000 000
10 000	10.0	10 000 000
100 000	100.0	100 000 000

13. REFERENCES AND FOOTNOTES

Capitalization

When referring to page numbers, paragraphs, etc. in footnotes or within parentheses, abbreviations should be used:

Running text	Footnotes/parentheses
number, numbers	no., nos.
page, pages	p., pp.
paragraph, paragraphs	para., paras.

IFAD agenda items in minutes

Agenda items should not be capitalized unless they are also document titles.

> "The Board approved the agenda as proposed, with the inclusion of an additional item under other business."

Referencing

In-text citations with links to reference lists or bibliographies are not permitted in governing body documents; these should be converted to footnotes and fully referenced.

Footnotes

Avoid excessive use of references in footnotes. These reduce readability and hinder multilingualism as the sources cited may not be available in all of IFAD's official languages. Easily verifiable facts do not require a source note.

Ensure that the sources provided are the most recent available, particularly in the case of flagship publications. Check the organization website for instructions on their preferred citation style:

The State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World 2025[1]

[1] FAO, IFAD, UNICEF, WFP and WHO. 2025. The State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World 2025 – Addressing high food price inflation for food security and nutrition. Rome.

Once an item has been referenced in a footnote, the reference should be repeated only when necessary for the sake of clarity or to change a specific element in the reference, such as a paragraph number.

Follow the United Nations Editorial Manual guidelines on how to present sources in footnotes.

Sequencing and punctuation

The word "footnote" is written in lowercase.

... (see footnote 9).

Place a full stop after all footnotes, however short.

---

[1] Per 1,000 live births.
[2] Estimated.
[3] https://www.ifad.org.

Footnote numbers should be written in superscript and be placed outside punctuation marks, with no intervening space. Follow the footnote number with a single space:

... on 2 July 2025.[1] According to recent reports ...
... was approved today,[3] but no provision has been made ...

In tables

A note to an item in a table should not be inserted as a footnote. Notes to a table should be typed manually, using superscript letters rather than numbers. Where there is only one note to a table, use an asterisk.

14. USEFUL RESOURCES

Web resources

CIAO2.0

Disability Inclusive Language Guidelines (United Nations)

FAO Term

Guidelines for gender-inclusive language (United Nations)

IFAD Policy on Engagement with Indigenous Peoples

Member States Interactive Platform

People

President's bulletin: Revised Corporate Guidelines for Governing Body Documents

Review of the Governing Body Documentation Guidelines

United Nations Editorial Manual

United Nations Terminology Database (UNTERM)

Key policies and strategies (2019–2025)

IFAD Knowledge Management Strategy
EB 2019/126/R.2/Rev.1

Information and Communication Technology for Development (ICT4D) Strategy
EB 2019/128/R.5

Revision of IFAD's Project Procurement Guidelines
EB 2019/128/R.40

Debt Sustainability Framework Reform
EB 2019/128/R.44

People, Processes and Technology Plan: Implementation of a Targeted Investment in IFAD's Capacity
EB 2020/129/R.3/Rev.2

Utilization of Resources under the IFAD Regular Grants Programme for the Implementation of the Private Sector Engagement Strategy and Other New Initiatives
EB 2020/129/R.26/Rev.1

IFAD's Liquidity Policy
EB 2020/131(R)/R.20/Rev.1

Regular Grants Policy
EB 2021/132/R.3

Revised IFAD Evaluation Policy
EB 2021/132/R.5/Rev.1

Borrowed Resource Access Mechanism: Framework for Eligibility and Access to Resources
EB 2021/132/R.9/Rev.1

IFAD Graduation Policy
EB 2021/133/R.5

Inclusive Rural Finance Policy
EB 2021/133/R.6

Enterprise Risk Management Policy
EB 2021/133/R.7

IFAD South-South and Triangular Cooperation Strategy 2022–2027
EB 2021/134/R.8

Establishment of IFAD's Euro Medium-Term Note Programme
EB 2021/133/R.11

Proposed Amendments to the Policies and Criteria for IFAD Financing and Adoption of the Framework on Financing Conditions
EB 2021/134/R.19

Annex I of the Revised IFAD Evaluation Policy
EB 2021/134/R.35

Multi-Year Evaluation Strategy of the Independent Office of Evaluation of IFAD
EB 2021/134/R.36

IFAD Strategy for Engagement in Small Island Developing States 2022–2027
EB 2022/135/R.5

IFAD's Policy on Disclosure of Documents for Non-Sovereign Private Sector Operations 2022
EB 2022/136/R.5

IFAD Policy on Engagement with Indigenous Peoples: an update
EB 2022/137/R.6

IFAD's Disability Inclusion Strategy 2022–2027
EB 2022/137/R.7

IFAD Data Governance Policy
EB 2022/137/R.8

IFAD Poverty Targeting Policy 2023
EB 2023/138/R.3

Internal Control Framework 2023
EB 2023/140/R.11

Anti-Money Laundering and Countering the Financing of Terrorism Policy 2023
EB 2023/140/R.12/Rev.2

IFAD Strategy on Diversity, Equity and Inclusion: Update
EB 2024/OR/R.6

Private Sector Operational Strategy 2025–2030
EB 2024/143/R.19

Revisions to the Framework for IFAD non-Sovereign Private Sector Operations and Establishment of a Private Sector Trust Fund
EB 2024/143/R.20

Policy on Handling Allegations of Misconduct against the President of IFAD
EB 2024/143/R.22

IFAD's non-Sovereign Operations Investment Strategy
EB 2025/145/R.15

Update to the IFAD Risk Appetite Statement
EB 2025/145/R.25

Climate, Environment and Biodiversity Strategy 2025–2031
EB 2025/146/R.17

Revised Capital Adequacy Policy
EB 2025/146/R.23/Rev.1

Revised Integrated Borrowing Framework
EB 2025/146/R.24

IFAD Nutrition Action Plan 2026–2031
EB 2025/146/R.34

IFAD Gender Action Plan 2026–2031
EB 2025/146/R.35

IFAD Rural Youth Action Plan 2026–2031
EB 2025/146/R.36

IFAD Project Procurement Handbook (for borrowers)

IFAD Project Procurement Manual (for IFAD staff and consultants)

IFAD's Policy to Prevent and Respond to Sexual Harassment, Sexual Exploitation and Abuse

15. WORD INDEX

A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

A

above-mentioned
abridgement
acknowledgement
aforementioned
aforesaid
absorptive capacity
(not: absorption capacity)
across-the-board (adj.)
across the board (adv.)
an across-the-board increase
an increase across the board
action research (= structured learning-by-doing)
action-oriented research
addendum (singular)
addenda (pl.)
add-on (n., adj.)
add on (v.)
ad hoc (no italics, no hyphen)
admissible
advertise
advice (n.)
advise (v.)
advisor (not: adviser)
aftermath
aftershock
afterthought
after-effect
after-hours (discussions, trading)
afterwards (not: afterward)
afterword (an epilogue)
ageism, ageing (not: aging)
age-profile models
age-selective
age-specific
agribusiness
agri-companies
agrifood
agrobiology
agrochemical(s)
agroclimate
agroclimatic
agroecology, agroecological
agroecosystem
agroentrepreneur
agroforestry
agropastoral, agropastoralists
agroprocessing
agro-dealer
agro-economy
agro-enterprise
agro-industry, agro-industrial
air conditioner, air conditioning (n.)
air-conditioned (adj.)
air-condition (v.)
aircraft (singular and plural)
airdrop
airfare
airfield
airfreight
airlift
airspace
air raid
air traffic control
aim
at + gerund (example: aim at attaining the objectives)
to + infinitive (example: aim to attain the objectives)
airmail
all-inclusive
all-purpose
all-round
all-terrain
all-weather
all-time (adj.)
all time (in prepositional phrase)
an all-time high
one of the greatest of all time
alley cropping
allot, allotted, allotting, allotment
Al-Qaida
alternate (n.)
a back-up person or substitute, as for a delegate; (adj.) every second one
amortize, amortization
anaemia
anaesthetic
analogue (but: analog in computer technology)
analyse (not: analyze)

Return to top

anti-
If followed by a word beginning with "i", use a hyphen:
anti-inflation, anti-inflammatory; anti-immune
If followed by an uppercase letter, use a hyphen:
anti-Arab; anti-American; anti-Japanese
anti-abortion
anti-aircraft
antibiotic
anticorruption
antidumping
anti-erosion
anti-money-laundering
anti-poverty
antipollution
antisocial
antitrust
annul, annulled, annulment
antennae (insects)
antennas (aerials)
appendix (singular)
appendices (plural)
aquaculture
Arab (noun only)
Arabic (adj.) e.g. the Arabic language
arm's length transaction(s)
arm's length quality assurance
as at (on a specific date)
as of (on and after a specific date)
Associate Vice-President
assure (distinguish between assure, ensure and insure)
assure people, ensure events, insure things
asylum-seeker
at-risk (adj.)
an at-risk project, at-risk groups
but: groups at risk, at risk of not achieving its goals
audio-visual
awareness-raising
axis, axes

B

backdrop
backhoe
backlog
backstop (n. and v.)
back to back (adv. phrase)
back-to-back (pre-positioned adj.)
seats placed back to back
a back-to-back letter of credit
back up (v.)
backup (n., adj.)
backward (adj.)
backwards (adv.)
balance of payments (n.)
balance-of-payments (adj.)
a deficit in the balance of payments
the balance-of-payments deficit
balance sheet
bandwidth
baseline (n. and adj.)
base-year (adj.)
bee-keeping (form to be preferred over "apiculture")
bee-keeper(s)
beforehand
benchmark (n. and v.)
benefit, benefited, benefiting
best-practice (adj.)
best practice (n.)
bi-
No hyphen is required after this prefix: biannual; biennial; bimonthly; biweekly
biannual (= twice a year, semi-annually, twice-yearly, six-monthly)
biennial (= every second year)
bimonthly
As this word means both "every two months" and "twice a month", it is better to use one of those phrases to prevent any confusion.
biweekly
As this word means both "every two weeks" and "twice a week", it is better to use one of those phrases to prevent any confusion.
bias (n., v.)
noun: bias, biases
verb: bias, biases, biasing, biased
bio-
No hyphen is required after this prefix, unless the unhyphenated word would cause difficulty in reading or pronunciation: e.g. bio-occlusion
birth control
birth rate
birthplace
birthright
birthweight
bitcoin

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blackout (n., adj.)
black out (v.)
bloc (coalition or alliance of persons, nations: currency, economic, political, power, trading blocs)
block (of shares; water, energy, power sales)
voting: a voting bloc (alliance of voters)
but: a block (unit) of votes
boldface (n.)
boldfaced (adj.)
bookkeeping
borehole
-born
firstborn (n., adj.) stillborn newborn (n., adj.)
born out, borne out
a solution born out of [=the consequence of] a desperate need
a hypothesis that has not been borne out [proved valid]
-borne
foodborne, waterborne (disease), airborne (pollution)
Less common compound words may require a hyphen:
insect-borne, vector-borne (in which case, only the first item is capitalized in titles: Combating Vector-borne Diseases)
bottleneck
brain drain
break away (v.)
breakaway (n., adj.)
break down (v.)
breakdown (n.)
break even (v.)
break-even (adj.)
break-even point
break-even analysis
break-out (adj.)
break-out room
break through (v.)
breakthrough (n., adj.)
break up (v.)
break-up (n., adj.)
-breeder, -breeding
cattle breeders, plant-breeding
broad-based
broad-minded
broadband
broadcast (n. and v. – both past and past participle)
broadside
budget, budgeted, budgeting
build up (v.)
build-up (n.)
built-in, built-up
(pre-positioned adj.)
built in, built up (past participle)
a built-in escalation allowance
a built-up area of the county
The borrower has built in an allowance for escalation.
The company has built up a huge database.
burden-sharing
bureau
bureaux
burka
burn, **burned**, **has burned**
bush fire
buy back (v.), **buy-back** (n., adj.)
buy down (v.), **buy-down** (n., adj.)
to buy down part of the interest payments; buy down the interest rate; an interest-rate buy-down
by-catch
by-election
by-product
by-laws uppercase form: **By-laws**
bypass (n., v., adj.)
bystander

C

calibre
calorie(s)
cancel, cancelled, cancelling, cancellation
capacity-building (n., adj.)
confidence-building (n., adj.)
caregiver
caretaker
carry forward (v.)
carry-forward (n.)
3 per cent carry-forward
case by case (adv.): The list will be examined case by case.
case-by-case (pre-positioned adj.): on a case-by-case basis
case study
cash crop
cash flow (n.): a meagre cash flow
the sustainable cash flow mechanism
cassava (not: manioc)
catalogue, catalogued, cataloguing
cattle 12 head of cattle, not 12 cattle

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cattle-raising (n., adj.)
cattle raisers
cave-in(s) (n.)
cave in (v., phrase)
centre, centred, centring
In editing, retain the spelling center, if it appears in the official name of a building or organization.
central government
channel, channelled, channelling
cheque (means of payment) not check
checklist
checkpoint
check up (v.)
check-up (n., adj.)
chef de cabinet
childbearing (n., adj.)
childbirth
childcare (n., adj.)
child-rearing
citywide (adj., adv.)
a citywide survey
searched citywide for ...
classroom
clean up (v.)
clean-up (n., adj.)
clear-cut (v., adj.), **clear-cutting**
clearing house
climate change (no hyphen)
climate-smart
cloakroom
closed-end
a closed-end investment fund;
closed-end management companies
co-
As a general rule, join the prefix co- to the stem with a hyphen:
co-author, co-locate
co-op, co-sponsor,
co-worker
Exceptions include:
coefficient, cooperate/cooperation/ cooperative; coordinate/ coordination/coordinator; coexecuting; coexist/coexistence; cofinance/cofinancing/cofinanced
cocoa bean (a cacao seed)
cocoa butter
combat, combated, combating
combatant
commit, committed, commitment, committing
compel, compelled, compelling
complement (to make complete, supplement)
compliment (to praise)
comprise/include
Comprise is used when all parts of a whole are named, and include when only some are:
The team comprises seven women and four men.
The team includes 11 people from Boston.
Comptroller General
Use the spelling **comptroller** for government financial officers and **controller** for corporate financial officers
consist of
to be made up of: Coal consists mainly of carbon.
control, controlled, controlling
cornerstone
cost accounting
cost-benefit analysis, ratio
cost-effective(ness)
cost-efficient, cost-efficiency
cost of living (n.)
cost-of-living (adj.)
an increase in the cost of living
a cost-of-living increase
cost recovery (n.)
counsel, counselled, counselling
counsel (n., sing. and pl.)
the Office of the General Counsel
counsellor
However, respect the spelling (i.e. with a single or double **l**) supplied by representatives even if this will leave a mixture of spellings for this title in a list of meeting participants.
councillor
elected member of a local government
counteract
counter-argument
counter-attack
counterbalance
counterclaim
counterclockwise
counterculture
counter-example
counter-guarantee
counter-insurgency
counter-intelligence
countermeasure
counterpoint
counterproductive
counter-revolution
counter-terrorism
countertrade
counter-urbanization

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country-level (adj., adv.)
country level (n.)
country-level programmes
… at the country level
countryside
countrywide (adj., adv.)
a countrywide survey
known countrywide
COVID-19
pre-COVID
craftworker – preferred English term for "artisans".
crisis (pl. **crises**)
crop dusting
crop farmer; crop-farming (n., adj.)
cropland
cross reference (n.)
cross-reference (v.)
cross-referenced
cross-referencing
cross section (n.)
cross-section (v.)
cross-section(al) (adj.)
cross-breed
cross-fertilize
cross-subsidize
crossover
crosswise
crosswind
cross-cutting
crowd in
crowding-in effect
crowd out (v.)
crowding out (n.)
crowding-out (adj.)
The public sector is crowding out the private sector.
Individuals and businesses are crowded out of credit markets.
Crowding out can cause economic activity to slow.
The crowding-out effect is evident.
crystallize
cure-all (n., adj.)
cut back (v., past participle)
cutback (n., adj.)
cut off (v., past participle)
cut-off (n., adj.)
cybersecurity

D

data (note: This word is plural in construction: "These data show that …")
databank
database
dataset
data collection (n.)
data processing (n.)
data-collection (adj.)
data-processing (adj.)
day care (n.)
day-care (adj.)
children in day care
day-care centre, day-care providers
day-to-day (adj.)
day to day (adv. phrase)
The director is in charge of the agency's day-to-day operations.
The low-income population lives from day to day.
de-
Unless this prefix is followed by the letter e, no hyphen is required:
demobilize, decommission
but: de-emphasize, de-energize
debt-equity ratio; debt-to-equity ratio; but: **ratio of debt to equity**
debt-equity swap;
debt-for-equity swap
debt-nature swap; debt-for-nature swap
debt-obligation guaranty (operation)
debt relief (n.)
debt-relief (adj.)
debt service (n.)
debt servicing (n.)
debt-service (adj.)
debt-servicing (adj.)
debt-service coverage, debt-service ratio
decision maker (n.)
decision-making (n., adj.)
decentralize (not: decentralise)
decentralization (not: decentralisation)
decree-law
Decreto-Ley 2.019 may be translated as "executive order 2,019" or "decree-law 2,019".
defence but: United States Department of Defense
de minimis
dependant (n.)
dependent (adj.)
de-risk
desktop
dialogue (n., v.)

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digitalization (not: digitization)
discernible not discernable
discreet (circumspect: a discreet person; discreet inquiries)
discrete (separate: discrete units. Also in econometrics: a discrete variable)
dispel, dispelled, dispelling
document Use lowercase even if followed by code: e.g. document EB 2007/89/R.55
donor dependence
donor-dependent
donor-funded
down-
As a rule, no hyphen is required after this prefix: download, downgrade, downsize, downstream, downtime
but: down-to-earth (adj.)
-down
As a rule, no hyphen is required in compound nouns ending in this suffix: breakdown, rundown, slowdown
A hyphen should be used in less common terms, particularly when the first element consists of two or more syllables: dressing-down
down payment (n.)
downward (adj., adv.)
draft (of a text)
draught (animals; of a ship; air current)
drawback (disadvantage; rebate of customs duties)
drawdown (the act of drawing on available loan facilities)
draw down (v.)
drawdown (n., adj.)
authorization to draw down (=draw on) the line of credit, the first drawdown of the line of credit
drift net (n.)
drift-net (adj.)
drinking water
drop out (v.)
dropout (n., adj.)
drought-affected
drought-prone; flood-prone
drug-taking (n. and adj.)
drug trafficking
dry land (land as opposed to sea)
dryland(s) (type of ecosystem)
dyeing (clothes)
dying (death)

E

e-
Always use a hyphen in words with an "e" prefix.
Capitalize the "e" when starting a sentence:
"E-mail addresses should …"
Capitalize both elements in headings and titles:
"Unlocking the Potential of E-Commerce in Development"
e-business
e-commerce
e-mail (not: email)
e-signature
ecoclimate
ecosystem
ecotourism
ecozone
elite capture
-end (in financial jargon)
closed-end (fund, mortgage)
open-end (clause, fund, lease, mortgage)
Compare with the general term open-ended (question, interview).
endeavour (n., v.) not endeavor
end product
end result
end user (noun) end-user (adj.)
end-borrower(s) (n., adj.)
rate charged to end-borrowers; end-borrower concerns
Note: The term "subborrower" is used at some IFIs for the end (final) borrower of a loan made to a (first) borrower, which then onlends the funds, often through one or more intermediaries. The term "end-borrower" is in common use elsewhere in the development lending community and can be used in IFAD documents.
English-speaking; non-English-speaking
the English-speaking Caribbean countries
enrol, enrolled, enrolling, enrolment
equal, equalled, equalling
equator
eurozone
evaluability
everyday (adj.) These are everyday concerns.

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every day (adv. phrase) The reports are filed every day.
everyone (pronoun) (=everybody) Everyone is here; we can begin.
every (adj.) **one** (=every single one) Every one of you can help.
ex ante, ex post
external auditor of IFAD
Always singular and in lowercase.

F

far-flung
-farming (n., adj.)
crop-farming, fish-farming, stock-farming, wheat-farming
far off (adv. phrase); **far-off** (adj.)
far off the beaten path
far-off places
farmer field school(s)
farmers' organizations
not: farmer organizations/farmers organizations
far-ranging
far-reaching
far-sighted
farther (adj.) more distant:
the farther side of town
further (adj.) additional:
with no further thought of consequences
fibreglass
fieldwork
fine-tune (v.)
fine-tuned (adj.)
fine-tuning (n.)
fintech
first-come, first-served
(on a _____ basis)
first-hand (adj., adv.)
a first-hand account; facts learned first-hand. (Rarely, as a noun: facts learned at first hand)
first quarter (n.)
first-quarter (adj.)
earnings in the first quarter
first-quarter earnings
first-rate (adj., adv.)
first-tier bank
fish farm (n.)
fish-farming (n., adj.)
fishmeal
fish oil
fishers not: fishermen, fisherfolk, fisherwomen
fishing communities
fit-for-purpose
fit-for-purpose institution
the institution should be fit for purpose
fixed-income investment
floodgate
flood plain
focus, focuses (n.)
focus, focusing, focuses, focused (v.)
-fold
When the number preceding this suffix is a single unhyphenated word, no hyphen is needed:
tenfold; hundredfold; thousandfold
With a figure, use a hyphen:
38-fold; 200-fold
follow up (v.)
will follow up on the request

follow-up (n., adj.)
close follow-up
a follow-up report
feed crop
food crop
foot-and-mouth disease
food-insecure (adj.)
The project will target food-insecure households.
Many of the households in the project area are food-insecure.
forbid, forbade (past), **forbidding**
forecast (v.) past tense forecast (not: forecasted)
forgo not forego (to abstain from, do without, dispense with: to forgo a raise)
forgone principal
but: **foregone conclusion**
forums (not: fora)
forward (adj. and adv.) not forwards
forfeit (n., v.); **forfeiting**
forfait(ing)
This spelling is used only in international finance, to denote the discounting of medium-term notes.
for-profit (adj.)

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a for-profit commercial concern
forward-looking
four-wheel drive (n.) – As an adjective: a four-wheel-drive vehicle
-free (compound forms hyphenated (e.g. disease-free)
free of charge (adv. phrase)
free-of-charge (adj.)
services offered free of charge
free-of-charge [=free] services
freelance translator; a freelance; to freelance
front-load (v.)
fuel, fuelled, fuelling
fuelwood
fulfil, fulfilled, fulfilling, fulfilment

G

gauge (n., v.)
gender-neutral
gender-sensitive
gender-specific
gender-transformative
-general, -General (in titles)
General Service (GS) posts
geographic, geographical
Adopt one and apply consistently.
germ plasm
Gini coefficient
goodbye
goodwill
grassroots (n., adj.)
grassroots concerns; seeking changes at the grassroots
grey (not: gray)
greenhouse; the **greenhouse** effect
ground floor
groundwater (n., adj.)
-growers, -growing
(in compound nouns)
rice-growers; vegetable-growing; wheat-growers
gruelling

H

haemoglobin
haemorrhage
hajj (note: "hajj pilgrimage" is redundant)
half
Hyphenate **half-** compounds that are used as adjectives or adverbs, whether they precede or follow the noun: half-asleep; half-timbered
half hour (n.)
half-hour (adj.)
half-hourly (adj., adv.)
bulletins on the half hour
waited one half hour
a one-half-hour wait
half-hour intervals
half-hourly news reports
half-time (adj., adv.)
a person hired to work half-time
half-truth
halfway (adj., adv.)
half-weekly (adj., adv.)
half year
half-year (adj.)
half-yearly (adj., adv.)
reports covering each half year from ___ to ___
(**Note:** The term "six months" or "six-month period" is often a more idiomatic rendering of the French and Spanish "semestre".)
at half-year intervals
required to report half-yearly
hand in hand (adv. phrase)
hand-in-hand (adj.)
These two problems go hand in hand.
a hand-in-hand approach
handmade
handover (n., adj.)
hand over (v.)
home-made
hands-off (adj.)
hands off (n. + prep.)
a hands-off approach
keep one's hands off a matter
hand-to-mouth (adj.)

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hand to mouth (adv. phrase)
The community's residents lead a hand-to-mouth existence.
They live hand to mouth.
handwriting, handwritten
hard copy
hardship (n., adj.)
hardware (n., adj.)
hardwood
hard-working
headlong
head-on (adj.)
head on (adv.)
a head-on collision
approach the matter head on
headquarters (not: HQ)
***healthcare (adj. and noun)**
home care (n.)
home-care (adj.)
help desk
haemorrhage
hereafter (after this point in time; henceforward)
hereinafter (in the following part of this document)
hereinabove (at a prior point in this document)
hereinbefore (in the preceding part of this document)
here below (at a subsequent point in this document)
heretofore (before this, up to this time) (=hitherto)
herewith (attached to this letter)
high-calibre (adj.)
high calibre (adj. + n.)
work of very high calibre
high-energy (adj.)
high-level (adj.)
high level (adj. + n.)
high-level meetings
meetings at a high level
highlands
highly
No hyphen is required when the word is used as a modifier:
highly concessional terms
countries that are highly indebted
high-quality (adj.)
high quality (adj. + n.)
high-quality work
work of high quality
high speed (adj. + n.)
high-speed (adj.)
vehicles travelling at high speed
high-speed rail transit
high-value (adj.)
historic(al)
A **historic event or occasion** is an important occurrence, one that stands out.
A **historical** event is any event that occurred in the past.
-holder
bondholder; landholder; policyholder
home country travel
home leave
homeowner(ship)
home page not homepage
homogeneous not homogenous
honorary
hothouse (n., adj.)
-hour
ampere-hour(s); kilowatt-hour(s); watt-hour(s); person-hour(s) (of consulting services)
-house (n., adj.)
clearinghouse, custom[s]house, boardinghouse, greenhouse
human resource, human resources (adj. phrase)
Both forms are correct, but usage should be consistent throughout a document. No hyphenation. Similarly: natural resource(s) management.
hydroelectric
hydropower
hydrosystem

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I

ibid. (usage notes - refer to https://www.un.org/dgacm/en/content/editorial-manual/footnotes/chap-05#B)
impassable (passage impossible: a bridge or road)
impassible (not: sensitive to pain and suffering)
inaccessible
inasmuch as
inbuilt
insofar as
income generation (n.)
income-generation (adj.)
income-generating activities (IGAs)
incur, incurred, incurring
in-depth study
but: to study in depth the effects of
Indigenous Peoples
when referring to cultures, communities, lands, languages, etc., of Indigenous Peoples, e.g. Indigenous culture in Ecuador; Indigenous languages are dying out
but indigenous if referring to flora or fauna
indices (numbers)
index, indexes (literary)
infrastructure (not: infrastructures)
indispensable
industry-wide (adj., adv.)
information and communications technology
infrared
in kind (adv.)
contributions in kind
in-kind (adj.)
in-kind contributions (only hyphenated in running text before a noun)
in presence (adv.)
delegates are invited to attend in presence
in-presence (adj.)
in-presence participation (only hyphenated in running text before a noun)
in session (adv.)
the item was discussed in session
in-session (adj.)
in-session discussions (only hyphenated in running text before a noun)
innocuous but **inoculate, inoculation**
inpatient (n., adj.)
outpatient (n., adj.)
input(s) (n.)
input (v.), **input** (past tense and past participle)
in-service (adj.)
in-service training
but: The elevator is not in service.
install, installed, installation, installing
instalment
instil, instilled, instillation, instilling
instilment
institution-strengthening (adj., unmodified noun)
institution-building
institutional development
-intensive
Hyphenate compound adjectives ending in -intensive, whether they precede the noun or appear in the predicate: capital-intensive project; projects that are labour-intensive
inter alia
interaction
interactive
inter-agency
inter-American
intercountry
inter-annual
intercropping
intercultural
interdepartmental
interdisciplinary
inter-ethnic
intergovernmental
inter-group
inter-industry
inter-institutional
interlinkage
inter-organizational
interprofessional
interprovincial
interracial
interregional
interrelate
intersectoral
intersessional
interspace
interstate
inter-unit
interest-bearing, non-interest-bearing (adj.)
internet

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intranet the IFAD intranet
intra-
As a general rule, a hyphen is required after this prefix only when the word following begins with a vowel or uppercase letter:
intra-European trade, intra-urban, intra-Andean commerce, intra-atomic, intra-industry,
This guideline concerning the use of a hyphen before a vowel is usually not followed in medical contexts – for instance, intraoral and intrauterine (although intra-abdominal).
Inward (adj.)
Inwards (adv.)
irreversible
irrevocable

J

jihad, jihadi

judgment (not: judgement)

K

keynote
keynote address
keynote speaker
kick-start (n., v.)
kilogram (not: kilogramme)
kilometre (not: kilometer)
know-how (n.)
knowledge-sharing (n., adj.)
knowledgeable
Koran (not: Qur'an, Quran)

L

labelled, labelling
labour
Do not capitalize when referring to a country's labour force as an organized segment of the economy ("labour-management relations"; "talks with labour").
labour force
landfill
landholder, landholding
landlocked
landowner, landowning
land use
land-use (adj.)
regulations governing land use
land-use regulations
lapse-of-time procedure
large scale
large-scale (adj.)
a project conceived on a large scale, a large-scale project
(as a main title) Medium- and Large-scale Projects
law, Law
civil law; criminal law
Use lowercase even when followed by a number: law 4,131
The names of laws enacted by a government or authority may be uppercased. The word Act can also be used in such cases:
the Foreign-Exchange Law; the Emergency Measures Act
the Central Bank Act;
the Law Governing Relations between ... References to laws are not uppercased when preceded by an indefinite article:
a law governing foreign-exchange transactions, a new budget law
lawmaker (n.)
law-making (adj.)
lay off (v.)
layoff (n., adj.)
lay out (v.)
layout (n.)
lead (v.)
to lead; it leads; it led (past); it has (had) led
learned (past tense, participle)
(not: learnt)
lengthwise
liaise
liaison
license (v.)
licence (n.)
life cycle (n.)
life-cycle (adj.)
lifelong
life-saving
lifespan
lifestyle

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lifetime
-like
Write common compounds ending in this suffix as one word:
childlike; businesslike; lifelike
except where this would result in a double or triple L:
cell-like; shell-like
Hyphenate temporary compounds (coined for a specific text):
nut-like; petal-like; Ghandi-like
A hyphen also is used in medical terms: malaria-like
local (adj.)
locale (n.)
logical framework
(thereafter: logframe)
log in, log on, log off, log out (v.)
login, logon, logoff, logout (n.)
-long as a suffix
Hyphens are used in all cases:
day-long; month-long; decade-long; century-long
long range
long-range (adj.)
short- and long-range plans
planning for the long range
long standing
long-standing (adj.)
a custom of long standing
a long-standing commitment
long term
long-term (adj.)
planning for the long term
short- and long-term debt
Report on Long-term Debt (document title)
long time
long-time (adj.)
partners who have worked together for a long time
a long-time partnership
low-emission
lowercase (n., adj., v.)
lower-middle-income (adj.)
low-income (adj.)
low income (n. phrase)
low-income segments of the population
a family with a low income
lowlands
lump sum
lump-sum (adj.)
payable in a lump sum; a lump sum of US$1,000
lump-sum payment, lump-sum contract
-ly
Compound modifiers consisting of an adverb ending in -ly (highly, fully and so on) do not require a hyphen before an adjective or past participle:
a highly developed technology base, fully satisfactory performance

M

macro (not hyphenated except for **macro-unit**)
macroeconomic(s)
but: macro- and microeconomics
make up (v. phrase)
make-up (n., adj.)
manageable, manageability
mango(es)
manoeuvre (n., v.) (not: maneuver)
marketplace
market town
marshal, marshalled, marshalling
meagre
medium-sized (adj.)
middle-sized
midsized
metadata
metalworking industry, **metalworkers**
micro
(not hyphenated except for micro-environment, micro-organism and micro-unit)
microentrepreneur(s)
microenterprise(s)
Avoid the construction "small and microenterprise", the expression "small enterprise" being two words, unhyphenated; an alternative is "small business(es) and microenterprise(s)".
mid- (as a prefix)
With few exceptions (for instance, before numbers and before a capital letter), no hyphen is needed after "mid": mid-Victorian, the mid-1970s, mid-1984.
midday
middle-income (adj.)
midpoint (n.)
midstep

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midterm (adj.)
midway (adj., adv.)
midweek
midyear
mileage
minefield (n., literal and figurative)
model, modelled, modelling
moneys, monies
moneys: different kinds of currencies
monies: funds
monocropping
month long (a ___, one ___)
month-long (adj.)
mosquito, mosquitoes
multi-
Compound forms are not hyphenated except for:

multi-access
multi-bilateral
multi-cause
multi-centre
multi-country
multi-donor
multi-ethnic
multi-faith
multi-purpose
multi-stakeholder
multi-skilled
multi-storey
multi-user
multi-utility
multi-year

N

nationwide (adj., adv.)
nearby (adj., adv.)
next of kin (n.)
next-to-last (adj.)
next to last (adv. phrase)
the next-to-last line
was ranked next to last in the appraisal
no later than (instead of "not later than")
non-
Generally hyphenated:
non-accrual (e.g. status), non-aligned (e.g. nations), non-compliance, non-English-speaking, non-existent, non-governmental organization(s), non-interest-bearing, non-lending, non-native, non-negotiable, non-oil, non-oil-producing countries, non-regional, non-reimbursable, non-traditional, non-performing (e.g. loans), non-profit
Exceptions:
nonconformist, nondescript, nonentity, nonfeasance, nonpareil
nonetheless
no-objection basis
no one
North-South (dialogue, trade relations)
not-for-profit
As some "non-profit" entities do "make" a profit (post a surplus), "not-for-profit" signals that they were not established for commercial gain.

O

occur, occurred, occurrence, occurring
-odd
twenty-odd
odour, odourless (not: odor)
odorous
off- (as a prefix)
off-farm (adj.)
…in such off-farm activities
off farm (adv.) …and other work done off farm
-off (as a suffix)
In nouns and adjectives, a hyphen is used:
cut-off, set-off, spin-off, trade-off, write-off
Exceptions include: layoff
The verb form consists of two words – (to) set off, trade off – as do nouns describing the process rather than the result:
the writing off of bad loans (but: loan write-offs)
When the two-word verb is used as an adjective, it is hyphenated:
the recently written-off loans (but: the loans were recently written off)
on-farm (adj.) …in such on-farm activities; …in such on- and off-farm activities
on farm (adv.) …and other work done on farm; …work done on and off farm

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off season (n.)
off-season (adj., adv.)
offset (n., v., adj.)
offsetting
Past tense and participle: offset
In 2021 the company offset its losses with the sale of assets.
It has offset its losses quickly.
offshore/**onshore** (adj., adv.)
offshoot
off site/**on site** (adv.) …facilities located on site; … working off site
off-site/**on-site** (adj.) …on-site supervision; …off-site processing
offence (not: offense) but: offensive
offhand
offtake
oilcake
oilfield
oilseed
oil meal
oil palm
oil well
-old
Compounds ending in -old should be hyphenated:
a year-old plan;
the centuries-old city of Rome.
one half (n.)
one-half (adj.)
one half of the world; one half mile (=one half of a mile)
a one-half-mile stretch of road
paid time and a half for overtime
The adjectival form is hyphenated: a one-half share
on- (as a prefix)
A hyphen is usually required before these prefixes, but see some common exceptions in following entries.
onboarding
ongoing
onlend, onlending, onlent
(not: on-lend)
This is the more idiomatic (and industry-preferred) rendering, rather than "sublending". Also used: **relend, relending**
on-the-job (adj.)
on the job (adv.)
We offer on-the-job training.
We provide training on the job.
onward (adj. and adv.)
oral (not: verbal)
Oral refers to spoken words (an oral report, as opposed to a written one). Verbal means expressed in words (either orally or in writing). In IFAD texts, it is rare that the word "verbal" is really intended.
organigram (not: organigramme) (but organization chart is the preferred term)
organization
But: retain the spelling organisation if it appears in the official name of an organization.
e.g.: Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD)
organization chart
-out (as a suffix)
In nouns, a hyphen is usually not required before this suffix:
blackout; fallout; walkout
The verb form consists of two words – (to) black out, to cut out – as do nouns describing the process rather than the result:
the blacking out of power systems
but: power system blackouts
When the two-word verb is used as an adjective, it is hyphenated:
a carefully thought-out plan (but: This plan has not been carefully thought out.)
outgoing
outmigrant
outmigration
Migration from one place in country X to another place within that country.
in-migrant
in-migration
Flows into a place in country X from places in that same country.
out-of-date (adj.)
out-of-date information
out of date (adv.)
information that is out of date
outpost
outsource
over- (as a prefix)
A hyphen is usually not required after this prefix:
overestimate, overreliance, override, overrun, oversupply
Exceptions include: over-abundant; over-represent
-over (as a suffix)
A hyphen is usually not required before this suffix in nouns and adjectives:
changeover, crossover, stopover
takeover, turnover
Exceptions include: carry-over

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The verb form of these terms consists of two words – (to) carry over, to take over.
When the two-word verb is used as an adjective, it is hyphenated:
the carried-over amounts (but: the amounts carried over to the following year)

overall (n., adj., adv.)

over all (prep. + adj.)
overalls (garment)
overall length, overall sales, overall picture
Overall, the quality is good. (=generally)
but: He prefers this course of action over all others.

-owner, -owning
One-syllable nouns (and their derivatives) are commonly joined to these words without a hyphen:
homeowner; homeownership; landowner; landownership; landowning

P

panellist
parallel, paralleled, paralleling
paralyse
parameter(s)
paramedical
paramilitary
parastatal
parliamentary
(procedure, prerogative)
part-time (adj., adv.)
part-time work
working part-time
part-way (adv.)
payroll
peacekeeper
peacekeeping
penholder
per cent
percentage
peri-urban
permissible
person-months
person-years
staff-years
Avoid: consultant/months, expert-months, man-months, man-years
personnel (see staff)
phasing-in (n.) **phase in** (v.)
phasing-out (n.) **phase out** (v.)
phenomenon, phenomena
piazza (not translated to square if part of place name)
pipeline
plough (n., v.) (not: plow)
point-blank (adj. and adv.)
policyholder
polycrisis
polycrises
policymaker
policymaking
post- (as a prefix)
Usually hyphenated:
post-1950, post-cold war, post-harvest
post-tsunami, post-session, post-war, but: postgraduate
practice (n.)
practise (v.)
prearrange
preconceive
precondition
predefine
predestined
predetermine
predispose
preheat
prehistory
prejudge
premarital
prenatal
preoccupy
prepaid
prerequisite
preschool
pre-COVID
pre-date
pre-eminent
pre-empt, pre-emptive
pre-establish
pre-financing
pre-screened
preselect
pre-session
preset

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presuppose
pre-exist, pre-existing
pre-investment
pre-modern
pre-qualify/pre-qualified
pre-register
present day (n. phrase)
present-day (adj.)
in the present day
present-day concerns
pretence
printout
private sector (adj. + n.)
concerns in the private sector
private sector concerns
privatize, privatization
(not: privatise, privatisation)
pro-poor
proactive (not: pro-active)
producers' organizations
not: producer organizations or producers organizations
profit, profited, profiting
program (n.) – in computing only
programme, programmed, programming
problem-solving (adj., n.)
promoter
prorate, prorated, prorating (v.)
provision(s), provisioning
loan loss provision(s), loan loss provisioning
public sector (adj. + n.)

Q

quintile
quinoa
quorum
quick-disbursing (loan)
synonym: fast-disbursing

R

rainfall
rainfed
rainforest
rainproof
rainwater
raising
cattle-raising; poultry-raising
re- (as a prefix)
A hyphen is usually not needed after this prefix unless the e is followed by another e, by a capital letter (rare), by the letters -re, or a hyphen is needed to distinguish between homographs:
reactivate
readmit
reaffirm
real effective exchange rate
reallocate
reappoint
rearrange
reauthorize
recost
redeploy
refinance
reforestation
reinforce
reissue
reorganize
reorient
resilience-building
retool
re-engagement
re-engineering
re-elect
re-emphasize
re-engage
re-establish
re-evaluate
re-examine
re-export
re-record
re-release
re-route
re-elect
re-entry
re-present (vs. represent)
recover (recoup, get back)
re-cover (cover again)
resort (have recourse to)
re-sort (sort again)
realize, realizable, realization
real time (n.)
real-time (adj.) (in data processing)
applications executed in real time
real-time processing, real-time control
recognize (not: recognise)
recur, recurred, recurrent, recurring
remodel, remodelled, remodelling
-resistant

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DDT-resistant; resistant to DDT; water-resistant
retrofit, retrofitting
reversible
reviser (not: revisor)
rice field
rice paddy
Richter scale
rigour (not: rigor)
risk-bearing (adj.)
roadmap
roll-out (n.)
roll out (v.)
Rome-based agency
roundtable (n., adj.)
(Governors' Roundtable)
run-off (n., adj.)

S

Sahel (the)
Sahelian zone
saleable
salt flat
salt marsh
salt pan
salt pit
salt water (n.)
saltwater (adj.)
scale up (v.) (not: "upscale")
scaled-up (adj.)
scaling up (n.)
school-age children
(but: children of school age)
schoolchildren
schoolteacher
sector
sectoral (avoid **sectorial)**
sector-wide (adj., adv.)
seed bank
self-
This prefix usually is followed by a hyphen in compound words:
self-assessment; self-contained; self-evaluation; self-knowledge; self-sustaining
When self is the root, no hyphen is used:
selfhood; selfless; selfsame
semi-annual, semi-annually
semi-arid
semi-autonomous
semi-independent
semi-official
semicircle
set back (v.)
setback (n.)
set up (v.)
set-up (n., adj.)
sewage (waste matter)
sewerage (system of drains)
sharecropper; sharecropping
sheikh
shelf-life
shopkeeper
shopkeeping
shortfall
short term (n.)
short-term (adj.)
shortlist
signal, signalled, signalling
signage
smallholder farmers
(not: small farmers)
small-scale (adj.)
sociocultural
sociodemographic
socioecology
socioeconomic
socio-political
soybean
specialize
spell, spelled (not: spelt)
staff (also personnel)
A collective noun that takes a plural verb when thought of as a number of individuals (the most common occurrence):
The staff are concerned.
The plural form "staffs" denotes two or more such assemblages (not: individual staff members):
The staffs of IFAD, FAO and WFP
Two IFAD staff members (not: two IFAD staffs or two IFAD staff)
Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) SDG 1 (not: SDG1)
spill over (v.)
spillover (n., adj.)
spin off (v.)
spin-off (n., adj.)
stand-alone (adj., n.)
a stand-alone document
networks versus stand-alones
stand by (v.)
They do not plan to stand by while this crisis is unfolding.

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standby (n., adj.)
an IMF standby arrangement
start up (v.)
start-up (n., adj.)
stationary (adj.) (not: moving)
stationery (n.) (paper)
stockpiling
straightforward
strikethrough
sub-account
sub-amendment
sub-area
sub-basin
sub-block
sub-branch
sub-centre
sub-delegation
sub-entry
sub-folder
sub-issue
sub-item
sub-office
sub-recommendation
sub-Saharan
sub-unit
subarctic
subatomic
subcategory
subcommission
subcommittee
subcomponent
subclause
subcontinent
subcontract
subculture
subdivision
subedit
subdistrict
subgrant
subgroup
subheading
subnational
suboptimal
subparagraph
subportfolio
subprogramme
subregion
subregional
subsection
subsector
substandard
subsystem
substructure
substandard
subtitle
subtotal
subsector
subset
sugar cane
summarize
superscript
supersede
supplementary funds
system-wide

T

take away (v.)
takeaway(s) (n.)
take over (v. phrase)
takeover (n., adj.)
targeted, targeting
tariff
task force
teamwork
therefore (thus; for that reason; accordingly; consequently)
therefor (following a noun: "for same")
Example: adjustments in the contract and the reasons therefor
think tank
twofold
tie, tied, tying
index-tied (adj.)
tie in (v.)
tied in (participle)
tie-in (n., adj.)
time-bound
time-consuming (adj.)
This is a time-consuming task.
This task is time-consuming.
timeframe
time lag
time limit
timeline
time period
time series
timescale
timespan
timetable
tomato(es)
ton (i.e. metric ton)
toolbox
topsoil
top-rated (adj.)
total, totalled, totalling
towards (not: toward)
town hall meeting
tradable

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trademark
trade off (v. phrase)
trade-off (n., adj.)
traffic, trafficked, trafficking
transfer, transferred, transferring
transferable, transferor
travel, travelled, travelling, traveller
turn around (v. phrase)
turnaround (n., adj.)
turn over (v. phrase)
turnover (n., adj.)

U

ultra-
Compounds are closed except for ultra-high frequency (UHF).
unaccounted-for
undercapitalized
underdeveloped
underemployment
underfunded
undernutrition
United Nations (avoid the abbreviation UN except when reproducing a title or a quotation)
United Nations system
underinvestment
underlie, underlying
underrate
underrepresent
underresourced
Undersecretary
Except for: Under-Secretary-General
under way (adv. phrase)
(not: underway)
unforeseen
-up (as a suffix)
In verbs, no hyphen used:
to break up, to build up, to check up, to scale up, to set up
In nouns and adjectives, a hyphen is always used: break-up, build-up, check-up, clean-up, follow-up, set-up
Except in the gerund form:
the breaking up of, the building up of, the checking up of, the scaling up of, the setting up of
uppercase (n., adj., v)
up front (adv. phrase)
up-front (adj.)
payment up front of a small fee
a small up-front fee
upgrade
upkeep
upriver
upstream
up to date (adv. phrase)
up-to-date (adj.)
upward (adj. and adv.)

V

value added (n., adj.)
greater value added
new value added requirements; value added tax
value chain (n., adj.)
value chain approach
veto(es)
vice-chairperson
vice-president
vice-minister
Deputy minister is a more idiomatic rendering in English.
videoconference
vigour (not: vigor)
vote by correspondence

W

wage earner
wage-earning
waste product
wastewater
waterborne
watercourse
water-food-energy nexus
waterline
waterproof
watershed
waterway
waterworks
water level
water supply
water table
web
webcam
webcast

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webinar
webmaster
website
webpage
weekday
weekend
well-being
well(-)____
Hyphenate as a compound adjective preceding a noun: She is a well-known economist.
Do not hyphenate when following a verb: He is well known in financial circles.
wetland(s)
whistleblower(s)
whistleblowing
wholehearted, wholeheartedly
-wide as a suffix
To standardize, it is suggested that a hyphen be used after a proper noun, following words of three or more syllables, and in terms that do not denote a geographical expanse or physical location:
Fund-wide (=throughout IFAD); Canada-wide
Citywide; countrywide; nationwide; statewide; worldwide
but:
(three syllables) hemisphere-wide; industry-wide
(not: geographical or physical location) sector-wide system-wide
When the unhyphenated form is especially uncommon or looks odd (e.g. provincewide), it is best to reword the text.
wide-ranging
widescreen
widespread
Wi-Fi
wildlife (n., adj.)
wilful, wilfully
-wise
As a rule, there is no hyphen in compound words ending with -wise:
crosswise; coastwise trade
women-headed households; households headed by women
workday
workflow
workforce
work permit
work-hour
working group
Capitalize when referencing a specific working group.
working hours
workload
workplace
workplan
worksheet
workshop
workspace
workstation
workstreams
workweek
World Bank
(not: WB)
write off (v.)
write-off (n.)
Example: debt write-offs (i.e. the writing off of bad debts)
wrongdoing

X

X-ray, X-rayed, X-raying (not: xray)

Y

year-end (n., adj.)
Many style manuals only accept as an adjective (year-end figures, a year-end report), but it is now established usage in the financial press, etc. (at year-end).
year-on-year
year-round
young people
youth
(not: youths)

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Z

zero, zeros

zero-based budgeting

Although be aware of IMF and World Bank usage if quoting from their texts: zero-base budgeting.

zero hunger

zero-tolerance

zero population growth

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16. ABBREVIATION LIST

3FS	Financial Flows to Food Systems
3S Initiative	Initiative for Sustainability, Stability and Security in Africa
4Ps	public-private-producer partnerships
AATI	African Agricultural Transformation Initiative
ABC Fund	Agribusiness Capital Fund
core ACC	core additional climate contribution
ADB	Asian Development Bank
ADF	Asian Development Fund
AECID	Spanish Agency for International Development Cooperation
AFD	Agence Française de Développement
AIIB	Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank
AfDB	African Development Bank
AfDF	African Development Fund
ALM	asset and liability management
ALO	Americas Liaison Office
ALP	asset and liability portfolio
APEC	Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation
APEX	Achieving Project Excellence in Financial Management
AR4D	agricultural research for development
ARIE	Annual Report on the Independent Evaluation of IFAD
ASAP	Adaptation for Smallholder Agriculture Programme
ASAP+	enhanced Adaptation for Smallholder Agriculture Programme
ASMCS	After-Service Medical Coverage Scheme
ATR	ability to respond
AVANTI	Advancing Knowledge for Agricultural Impact
AVP	Associate Vice-President
AWPB	annual workplan and budget
BFFS.JP	Belgian Fund for Food Security Joint Programme
BOS	Business Operations Strategy (RBA terminology)
BPR	business process re-engineering
BPs	basis points
BRAM	Borrowed Resource Access Mechanism
CAF	Development Bank of Latin America
CAR	Climate Action Report
CBAM	carbon border adjustment mechanism
CBO	Common Back Office (RBA terminology)
CCA	climate change adaptation
CCA	common country analysis
CCF	credit conversion factor
CCR	COSOP completion report
CDC	Centers for Disease Control and Prevention
CDD	community driven development
CEB	United Nations System Chief Executives Board for Coordination
CGAP	Consultative Group to Assist the Poor
CIAT	International Center for Tropical Agriculture
CIS	climate information services
CFS	Committee on World Food Security
CLE	corporate-level evaluation
CLEAR	Centers for Learning on Evaluation and Results
CLPE	country-level policy engagement
CMT	contract monitoring tool
CO2	carbon dioxide
COI	core outcome indicator
COSOP	country strategic opportunities programme
CPs	conditions precedent
CPE	country programme evaluation
CPI	consumer price index
CPIA	country policy and institutional assessment
CPL	concessional partner loan
CPO	country programme officer
CRC	Contracts Review Committee
CRD	Corporate Risk Dashboard
CRP	conference room paper
CRR	COSOP results review
CSN	country strategy note
CSO	civil society organization
CSPE	country strategy and programme evaluation
CVaR	conditional value at risk
D2.0	Decentralization 2.0
DAC	Development Assistance Committee (of OECD)
DC	deployable capital
DEF	Development Effectiveness Framework
DEI	diversity, equity and inclusion
DELIVER	Driving Delivery of Results in the Agriculture Sector
DFI	development finance institution
DHC	blend of Debt Sustainability Framework and highly concessional lending terms
DMR	divisional management result
DoA	delegation of authority (Delegation of Authority Framework)
DRE	debt reduction equivalent
DSF*	Debt Sustainability Framework
DWP	dynamic workforce planning
EAD	exposure at default
EBRD	European Bank for Reconstruction and Development
ECB	European Central Bank
ECD	evaluation capacity development
ECG	Evaluation Cooperation Group
ECL	expected credit loss
ECOWAS	Economic Community of West African States
ECSA	Executive Committee of the Staff Association
EDA	effective development assistance
EFA	economic and financial analysis
EIB	European Investment Bank
EIRR	economic internal rate of return
EMC	Executive Management Committee
EMTN	IFAD's Euro Medium-Term Note Programme
ENRM	environment and natural resources management
EPR	external peer review
EQA	External Quality Assessment
ERM	enterprise risk management
ERMC	Enterprise Risk Management Committee

ERMF	Enterprise Risk Management Framework
ESCMP	Environmental, Social and Climate Management Plan
ESG	environmental, social and governance
ESMP	Environmental and Social Management Plan
ESMS	environmental and social management system
ESR	evaluation synthesis report
ESS	environmental and social standards
EURIBOR	Euro Interbank Offered Rate
EVE	economic value of equity
FARM	Food and Agriculture Resilience Mission
FALCO	Investment, Finance and ALM Advisory Committee
FAO	Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations
FARMS	Facility for Refugees, Migration, Forced Displacement and Rural Stability
FCAS	fragile and conflict-affected situations
FDI	foreign direct investment
FFR	Financing Facility for Remittances
FGWB	IFAD Fund for Gaza and the West Bank
FIPS	Faster Implementation of Project Start-up
FIs	financial intermediaries
FISCO	Investment and Finance Advisory Committee
FMFCL	financial management and financial control arrangements letter
forex or FX	foreign exchange
FOs	farmers' organizations
FPIC	Free, Prior and Informed Consent
FRMC	Financial Risk Management Committee
FRMU	Financial Risk Management Unit
FTE	full-time equivalent
FVTPL	fair value through profit and loss
GAFSP	Global Agriculture and Food Security Program
GALS	Gender Action Learning System
GBFF	Global Biodiversity Framework Fund
GCF	Green Climate Fund
GDI	Graduation Discussion Income
GDPRD	Global Donor Platform for Rural Development
GEF	Global Environment Facility
GEWE	gender equality and women's empowerment
GGWI	Great Green Wall Initiative
GIS	geographic information system
GIZ	German Agency for International Cooperation
GNI	gross national income
GNIpc	gross national income per capita
GNP	gross national product
GPGs	global public goods
GRIPS	Grants and Investment Projects System
GRM	grievance redress mechanism
GSS	Global Staff Survey
GTM	Gender Transformative Mechanism
HDI	Human Development Index
HIPC	Heavily Indebted Poor Countries
HR	human resources
HRIP	Human Resources Implementing Procedures
IAI	Impact Assessment Initiative
IASB	International Accounting Standards Board
IBF	Integrated Borrowing Framework
IBRD	International Bank for Reconstruction and Development
ICF	Internal Control Framework
ICIs	intermediary credit institutions
ICO	IFAD Country Office
ICP	IFAD Client Portal
ICT	information and communications technology
ICT4D	information and communications technologies for development
IDA	International Development Association
IDB	Inter-American Development Bank
IDB Lab	innovation lab of the Inter-American Development Bank
IDD	integrity due diligence
IDP	internally displaced person
IE	impact evaluation
IFAD13	Thirteenth Replenishment of IFAD's Resources
IFC	International Finance Corporation
IFFIm	International Finance Facility for Immunisation
IFI	international financial institution
IFPRI	International Food Policy Research Institute
IFRS	International Financial Reporting Standards
IGA	income-generating activity
IICA	Inter-American Institute for Cooperation on Agriculture
IITA	International Institute of Tropical Agriculture
ILC	International Land Coalition
ILO	International Labour Organization
ILOAT	Administrative Tribunal of the International Labour Organization
IMF	International Monetary Fund
INBAR	International Bamboo and Rattan Organisation
INGO	international non-governmental organization
IOCs	instruments of contribution
IOG	institutional output group
IPAF	Indigenous Peoples Assistance Facility
IPCC	Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change
IPRM	integrated project risk matrix
IPS	Investment Policy Statement
IRR	internal rate of return
ISA	IFAD Staff Association
IsDB	Islamic Development Bank
ISO	International Organization for Standardization
IVI	IFAD Vulnerability Index
KfW	KfW Development Bank
KM	knowledge management
KMCG	Knowledge Management Coordination Group
KPI	key performance indicator
KRI	key risk indicator
LDN	land degradation neutrality
LGD	loss given default
LIBOR	London Interbank Offered Rate
LIC	low-income country
LMIC	lower-middle-income country
LOT	lapse-of-time (procedure)
M&A	mergers and acquisitions
M&E	monitoring and evaluation
MAP	multiphase adaptive programme

MCO	multi-country office
MDB	multilateral development bank
MDD-W	Minimum Dietary Diversity for Women
MDGs	Millennium Development Goals
MEAL	monitoring, evaluation, adaptation and learning
MFI	microfinance institution
MFS	(countries with the) most fragile situations
MIC	middle-income country
MIS	management information system
MLR	minimum liquidity requirement
MOPAN	Multilateral Organisation Performance Assessment Network
MOSS	United Nations Minimum Operating Security Standards
MoU	memorandum of understanding
MRG	Management Review Group
MSIP	Member States Interactive Platform
MSME	micro, small and medium-sized enterprise
MSPs	multi-stakeholder platforms
MTP	medium-term plan
MTR	midterm review
NAPs	National Adaptation Plans
NAV	net asset value
NBSAPs	national biodiversity strategies and action plans
NCC	net contributor country
ND-GAIN	Notre Dame Global Adaptation Index
NDC	Nationally Determined Contribution
NOB	National Professional Officer, level B
NOC	National Professional Officer, level C
NORAD	Norwegian Agency for Development Cooperation
NPLs	non-performing loans
NPV	net present value
NRM	natural resources management
NSOs	non-sovereign operations
ODA	official development assistance
OECD	Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development
OMC	Operations Management Committee
OMT	Operations Management Team (RBA terminology)
OPAC	IFAD's Operations Academy
OPEC	Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries
OPEC Fund	OPEC Fund for International Development
OPEN	Online Project Procurement End-To-End System
OpEX	Operational Excellence for Results
ORMC	Operational Risk Management Committee
ORMS	Operational Results Management System
OSC	Operational Strategy and Policy Guidance Committee
PAD	portfolio performance and disbursement
PAR	portfolio-at-risk
PARM	Platform for Agricultural Risk Management
PBAS	performance-based allocation system
PCE	project cluster evaluation
PCN	project concept note
PCR	project completion report
PCRV	project completion report validation
PCS	preferred creditor status
PCU	project/programme coordination unit
PD	probability of default
PDB	public development bank
PDR	project design report
PDRC	Programme Delivery Risk Committee
PDT	project delivery team
PES	performance evaluation system
PIM	project implementation manual
PMC	programme management committee
PMU	project/programme management unit
PO	purchase order
PoLG	programme of loans and grants
PoW	programme of work
PPA	project performance assessment
PPE	project performance evaluation
PPTP	People, Processes and Technology Plan
PRiME	Program in Rural Monitoring and Evaluation
PRISMA	President's Report on the Implementation Status of Evaluation Recommendations and Management Actions
PSC	project steering committee
PSFP	Private Sector Financing Programme
PSP	project supervision report
QAIP	quality assurance and improvement programme
R&D	research and development
RAC	resources available for commitment
RBA	Rome-based agency
RBL	results-based lending
RESOLVE	Results-based Management for Rural Transformation
RIDE	Report on IFAD's Development Effectiveness
RIME	Report on IFAD's Mainstreaming Effectiveness
RIMS	Results and Impact Management System
RMF**	results management framework
RPSF	Rural Poor Stimulus Facility
RSP	rural sector performance
RSPA	rural sector performance assessment
RTA	reimbursable technical assistance
S&P	Standard & Poor's
SACCOs	savings and credit cooperative organizations
SAFIN	Smallholder and Agri-SME Finance and Investment Network
SARP	Smallholder Agribusiness and Resilience Project
SBF	Sovereign Borrowing Framework
SCF	sustainable cash flow approach
SD3C	Joint Programme for the Sahel in Response to the Challenges of COVID-19, Conflict and Climate Change
SDC	Swiss Agency for Development and Cooperation
SDG	Sustainable Development Goal
SDR	special drawing rights
SECAP	Social, Environmental and Climate Assessment Procedures
SH/SEA	sexual harassment/sexual exploitation and abuse
SHIBOR	Shanghai Interbank Offered Rate
SIDS	small island developing states
SIF	Smallholder and Small and Medium-Sized Enterprise Investment Finance Fund
SIS	supervision and implementation support
SME	small and medium-sized enterprise
SO	strategic objective
SOE	statement of expenditure

SOFI	State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World
SOFR	Secured Overnight Financing Rate
SONIA	Sterling Overnight Index Average
SRE	subregional evaluation
SRI	socially responsible investment
SSTC	South-South and Triangular Cooperation
SWP	strategic workforce planning
TA	technical assistance
TCI	Targeted Capacity Investment
TE	thematic evaluation
TLL	target liquidity level
ToC	theory of change
TONAR	Tokyo Overnight Average Rate
ToRs	terms of reference
UMIC	upper-middle-income country
UNCT	United Nations Country Team
UNDFF	United Nations Decade of Family Farming
UNDP	United Nations Development Programme
UNDS	United Nations Development System
UNDSS	United Nations Department for Safety and Security
UNEG	United Nations Evaluation Group
UNEP	United Nations Environment Programme
UNFCCC	United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change
UNFSS	United Nations Food Systems Summit
UNICEF	United Nations Children's Fund
UNJSPF	United Nations Joint Staff Pension Fund
UNPFII	United Nations Permanent Forum on Indigenous Issues
UNSDCF	United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Framework (formerly UNDAF)
UNSDG	United Nations Sustainable Development Group
USAID	United States Agency for International Development
VACS	Vision for Adapted Crops and Soils
VfM	value-for-money
WFP	World Food Programme
WHO	World Health Organization
WIGSI	within-grade step increment
WRMF	Weather Risk Management Facility

***** Refer to "grants to countries in debt distress" rather than "DSF countries".

** Capitalize only when referring to a specific replenishment RMF, i.e. IFAD14 Results Management Framework.